OptionIQ

Understand Risk. Protect Capital.

User Manual & Training Guide

Every tab, every button, step by step

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QUANTUM NEXUS LLC

Building Intelligent Solutions for a Smarter Future

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How to use this manual

This manual is both a reference and a training course. It explains every screen, every button and every box in OptionIQ, in plain language, with a picture of each one.

- **New to OptionIQ?** Read Part 1 first. It takes you from the zip file to your first trade. Then try the practice exercises in Chapter 20.
- **Looking for one button?** Use the **Contents** on the next pages, or the **Index** at the back. The index lists words in A to Z order with the page where each one is explained.
- **Orange numbered circles** in the pictures match the numbered rows in the table under each picture.

All the pictures use **made-up practice trades** in three made-up accounts called Roth IRA, Brokerage and Spouse IRA. The tickers are real companies, but the prices, trades and amounts are not real.

What you see in this manual	What it means
Bold words	A button, tab or box exactly as it appears on screen.
⚙️ Settings → About	Click ⚙️ Settings, then go to the About part.
Tip boxes	A shortcut or good habit.
Careful boxes	Something that changes or replaces your information.

OptionIQ is a record-keeping and research tool. It never places trades and it is not financial advice. Always check prices and details with your broker before you trade.

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Part 1. Getting started

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1. Welcome to OptionIQ

OptionIQ keeps a log of the options you sell or buy and the stocks you own, in each of your brokerage accounts. It works out your profit and loss, warns you before options expire, and helps you find and judge new trades.

Everything stays on your own computer, in one folder. Nothing is sent anywhere except ticker symbols when the app looks up prices, and a regular check for a new version of the app.

What OptionIQ can do for you

Area	What it does	Chapter
📋 Options	Logs every option trade, open and closed, with live profit and loss	6
🏦 Stocks	Tracks the shares you own, including shares you got from an assigned put	7
📊 My Results → 📈 Analytics	Charts of your profit by ticker, month and week, and the money set aside for puts	8
📊 My Results → 🏅 Scorecard	Honest results: return on the money at risk, rolls, strategies, sectors, and a comparison with the index	9
🔍 Find Trades → 🎯 Screen my Watchlist and 🔁 Roll my options	Finds new put and covered-call trades, and suggests rolls for trades you hold	10
🔬 Stock Research → Stock Analysis	A buy / hold / trim view of every stock you own or watch	11
🔍 Find Trades → 🔭 Screen S&P 500	Scans the whole S&P 500 for new names worth watching	12
🔬 Stock Research → ⭐ Edit my Watchlist and 👁️ Watchlist facts	Your list of stocks to follow, and a health card for each one	13
📅 Calendar	Each open option on the day it expires	14
📁 Data & Files → ⬆ Import trades from a file	Brings in your spreadsheets and your Fidelity downloads: new trades, closes, stock buys and sells, reinvested dividends, and a check of your shares and cost per share	15
🔔 Reminders	Expiring options, options past expiry, and backups that are due	16
📱 Phone app	See your trades on your iPhone or Android phone, log and close trades, and add to your watchlist	19

A few words you will see often (the Glossary in Chapter 22 has more)

Word	Meaning
Put	An option that lets the buyer sell 100 shares to you at the strike price. When you **sell** a put you are paid a premium and promise to buy the shares if the price falls below the strike.

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Word	Meaning
Call	An option that lets the buyer buy 100 shares from you at the strike price. A **covered call** is a call you sell on shares you already own.
Premium	The money paid for an option, per share. One contract covers 100 shares, so a $1.20 premium is $120 per contract.
Strike	The price at which the shares would change hands.
Expiry	The last day of the option.
Net P&L	Profit and loss after the small fee the app subtracts for each contract.

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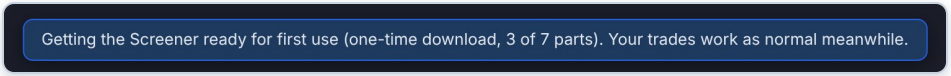
2. Installing OptionIQ

On Windows

You need the file **OptionIQ.zip** and a Windows 10 or 11 computer. Nothing else has to be installed.

1. **Make a new, empty folder** for the app. For example, right-click your Desktop, choose **New → Folder**, and name it `OptionIQ`.
2. **Move the zip file into that folder.**
3. **Right-click the zip file** and choose **Extract All...**.
4. Windows suggests a new folder with the zip's name. **Delete that last part** so the box shows only your new folder, then click **Extract**. (If you leave it, everything ends up one folder deeper. That still works.)
5. Open the folder. You should see **Start OptionIQ**, **READ ME FIRST**, **README** and a folder called **app**.
6. **Double-click Start OptionIQ.** If a blue box says **"Windows protected your PC"**, click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. Windows asks this only once.
7. The app opens in its own window after a few seconds. To close it, close the window.

The first time only, the app downloads the parts the Screener needs (about 30 MB, usually a minute or two). A blue message at the bottom shows how far along it is. Your trades work as normal meanwhile.



The one-time download message at the bottom of the screen on first start

If the message turns red, the download didn't work. Check your internet and click **Try again**.

Desktop icon. The first time OptionIQ starts, it puts an **OptionIQ** icon on your desktop. Double-click it to start the app each day. If you delete it, ⚙️ Settings → About has a button to put it back.

On a Mac

On a Mac you need **OptionIQ for Mac.zip** and macOS 11 (Big Sur) or newer. It works on Apple-chip and Intel Macs. Everything after this section is the same on a Mac.

1. Put the zip file where you want the app to live, for example in **Documents**.
2. **Double-click the zip file.** The Mac unzips it into a new folder called **OptionIQ**. Open it.
3. **Double-click Start OptionIQ.command.** The first time, the Mac says it can't check the file. Click **Done**, open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down to **"Start OptionIQ.command" was blocked**, click **Open Anyway**, enter your Mac password if asked,

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and click **Open Anyway** again. On macOS 14 or earlier you can instead right-click the file, choose **Open**, then **Open**. You do this only once.

4. A **Terminal** window opens. The first time only, it downloads the app's own copy of Python (about 20 MB). When it says OptionIQ is starting, you can close the Terminal window.
5. The app opens in its own window if Chrome, Edge or Brave is installed; otherwise it opens in Safari.
6. To close it, press **⌘ Command + Q** in its window, or close its Safari tab.

> **Tip:** OptionIQ also puts an icon on your Mac desktop. Double-click it to start the app without a Terminal window. The Terminal window closes by itself, and OptionIQ stops a few seconds after you close its window.

Already open? If you start OptionIQ again (from the icon, or Start OptionIQ) while it is still running, it simply brings up its open window instead of starting a second copy.

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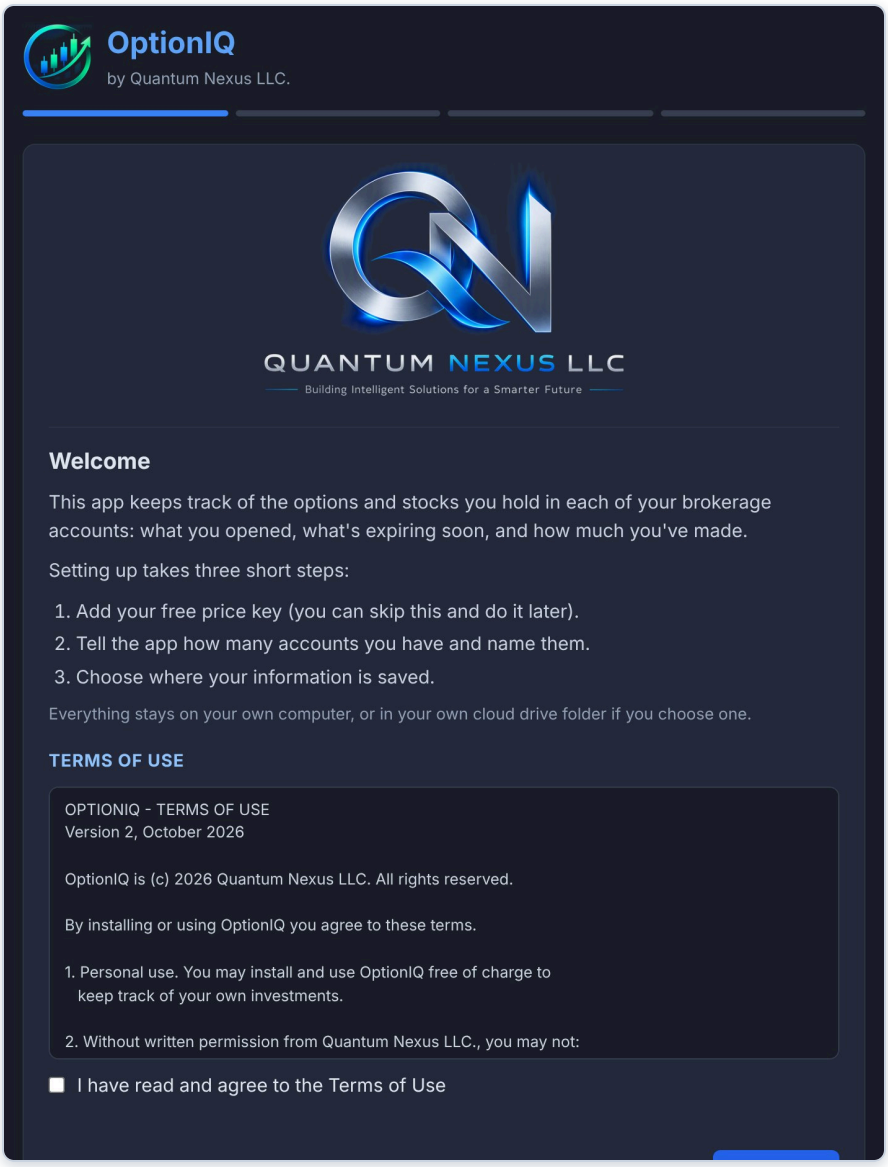
3. First-time setup

The first time it opens, OptionIQ shows a short setup. You can change every answer later in ⚙️ Settings.

Step 1: Welcome and Terms of Use



The Welcome screen

Read the Terms of Use in the box. Tick **I have read and agree to the Terms of Use**, then click **Get started**. The button stays grey until the box is ticked.

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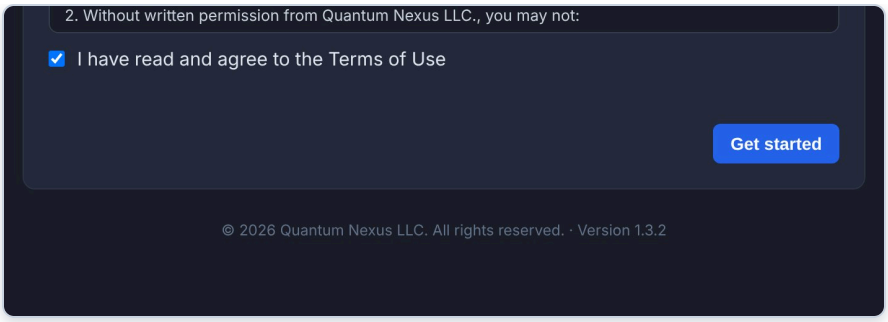
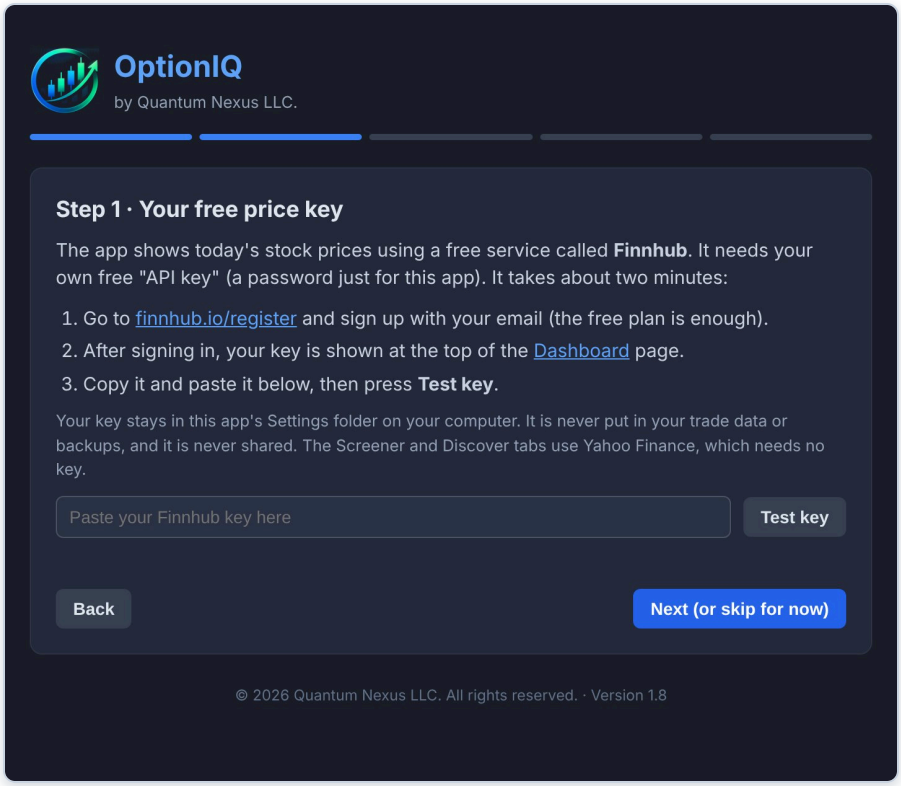


Tick the box, then Get started turns blue

Step 2: Your free price key



Setup step 1 of 4: the price key

Paste your free Finnhub key and click **Test key**, or click **Next (or skip for now)** and add it later. Chapter 4 shows how to get a key in about two minutes.

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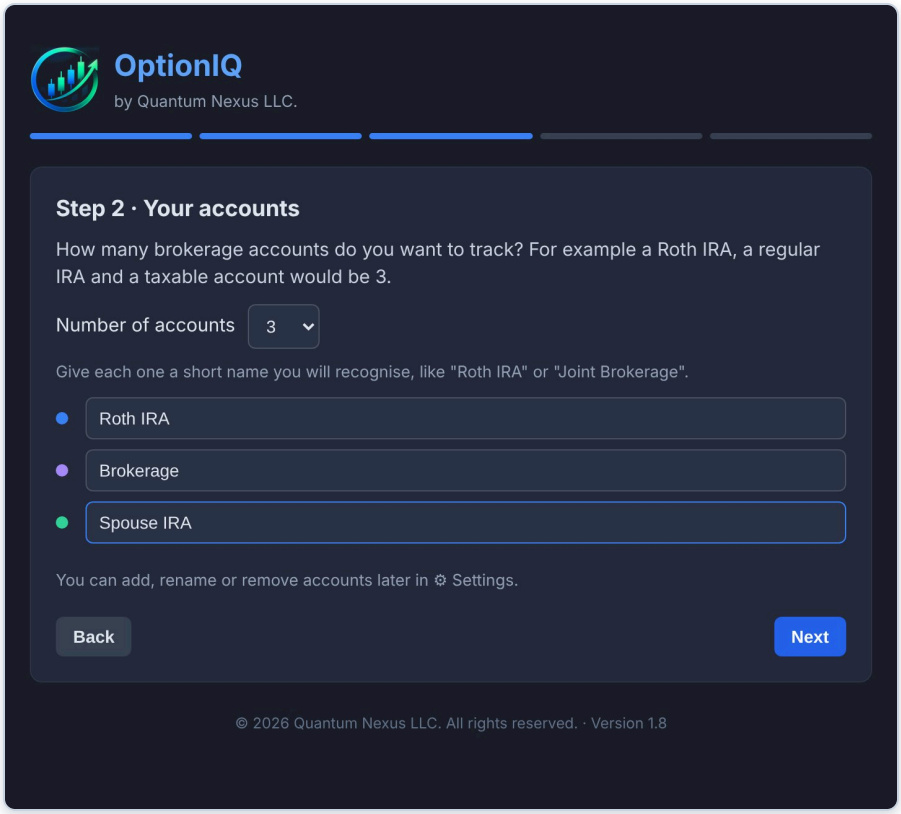
Step 3: Your accounts



Setup step 2 of 4: choose how many accounts and name each one

Choose how many brokerage accounts you have (1 to 10) and type a short name for each, such as "Roth IRA" or "Joint Brokerage". Each account gets its own colour, used everywhere in the app.

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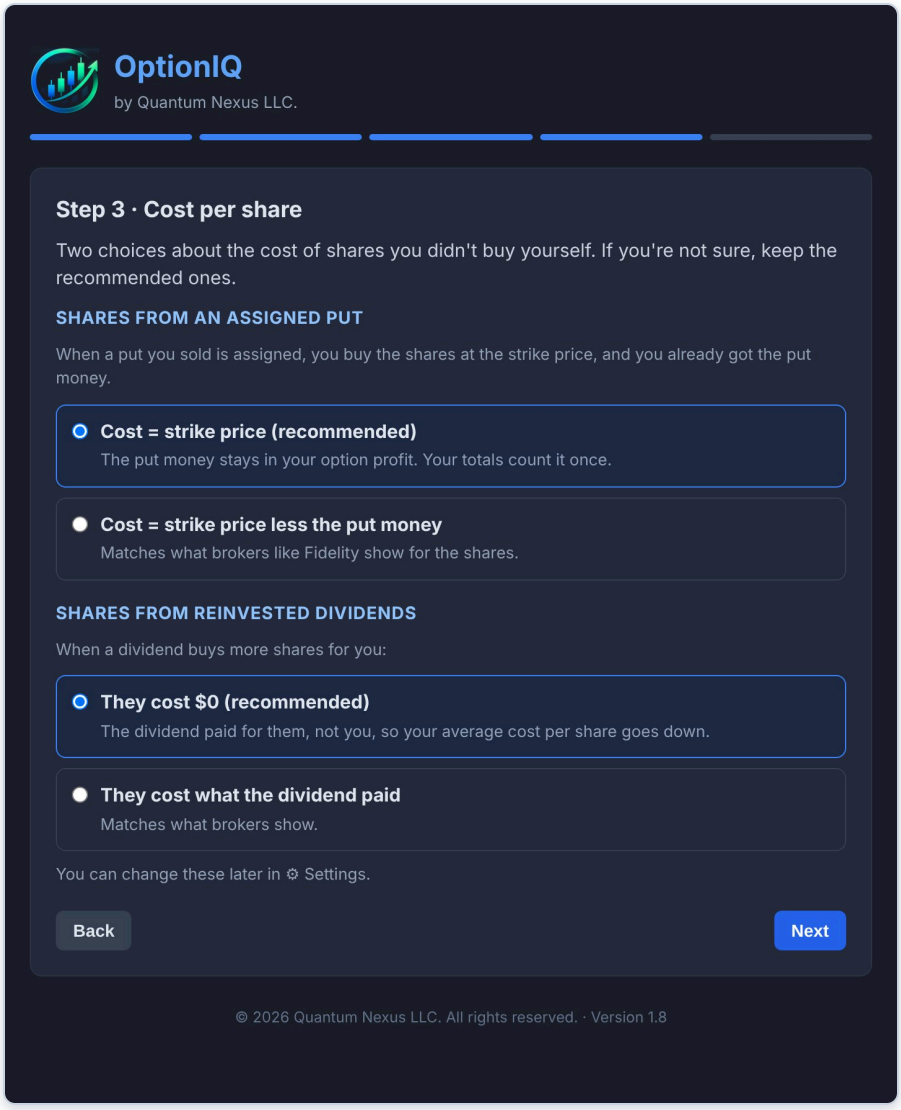
Step 4: Cost per share



Setup step 3 of 4: two choices about the cost of shares you didn't buy yourself

These two choices matter when you bring in files from your broker (Chapter 15) or close a put as Assigned. If you're not sure, keep the recommended ones.

- **Shares from an assigned put. Cost = strike price (recommended)** keeps the put money in your option profit, so your totals count it once. **Cost = strike price less the put money** matches what brokers like Fidelity show for the shares.
- **Shares from reinvested dividends. They cost $0 (recommended)**: the dividend paid for them, not you, so your average cost per share goes down. **They cost what the dividend paid** matches what brokers show.

You can change both later in ⚙️ Settings → Cost per share. A change is used from then on; shares already in the app keep their cost.

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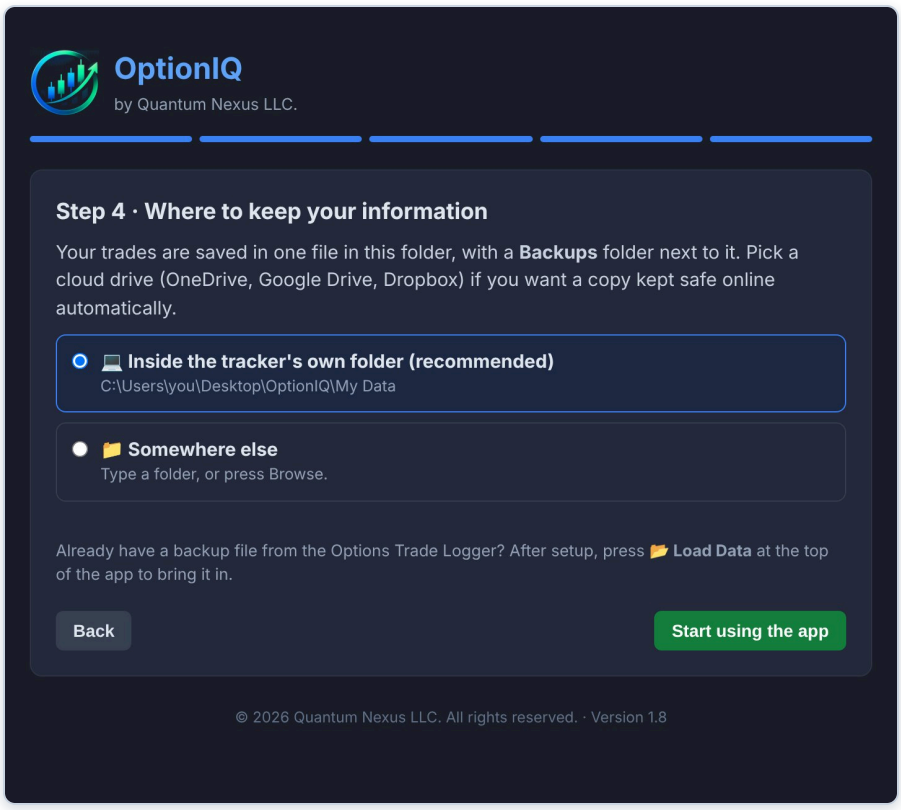
Step 5: Where to keep your information



Setup step 4 of 4: where your information is kept

Choose **Inside the tracker's own folder (recommended)** so everything stays together, then click **Start using the app**.

Already used the browser version (Options Trade Logger)? After setup, click 📂 **Restore from a backup** and pick your backup file. Chapter 15 explains.

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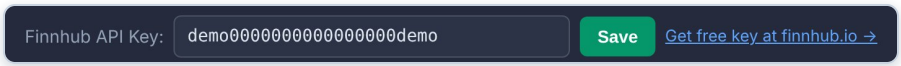
4. Getting your free price key

A key (an "API key") is like a password that lets the app fetch today's stock prices from a free service called **Finnhub**. The 🔄 **Update Prices** button needs it. Screen my Watchlist, Roll my options, Screen S&P 500, Stock Analysis and Watchlist facts use Yahoo Finance, which needs no key.

Everyone gets their own key, free. Never share yours or use someone else's. The app never comes with a key in it.

1. In your web browser, go to **finnhub.io/register**.
2. Enter your email and a password, then click **Sign up**. If Finnhub emails you, click the link in that email to confirm.
3. Sign in. On your **Dashboard**, near the top, is **API Key** followed by a long line of letters and numbers.
4. Select that line, right-click and choose **Copy**.
5. In OptionIQ, paste it into the key box (in setup, in ⚙️ Settings → Price key, or with ⚙️ Settings ▾ → 🔑 Price key on the top bar) and click **Test key**.



⚙️ *Settings ▾ → 🔑 Price key opens this bar. Paste the key and click Save. The link opens the Finnhub sign-up page.*

What the app says	What to do
The key works	Nothing. It's saved.
Finnhub didn't accept that key	It was only partly copied. Copy and paste it again.
Couldn't reach Finnhub	Check your internet connection and try again.

The free plan is enough; you never enter payment details. Your key is kept only in the app's **Settings** folder, never in your trades or backups. When a key is saved, the menu item reads 🔑 **Price key ✓**; with no key, the ⚙️ Settings heading is shown in red.

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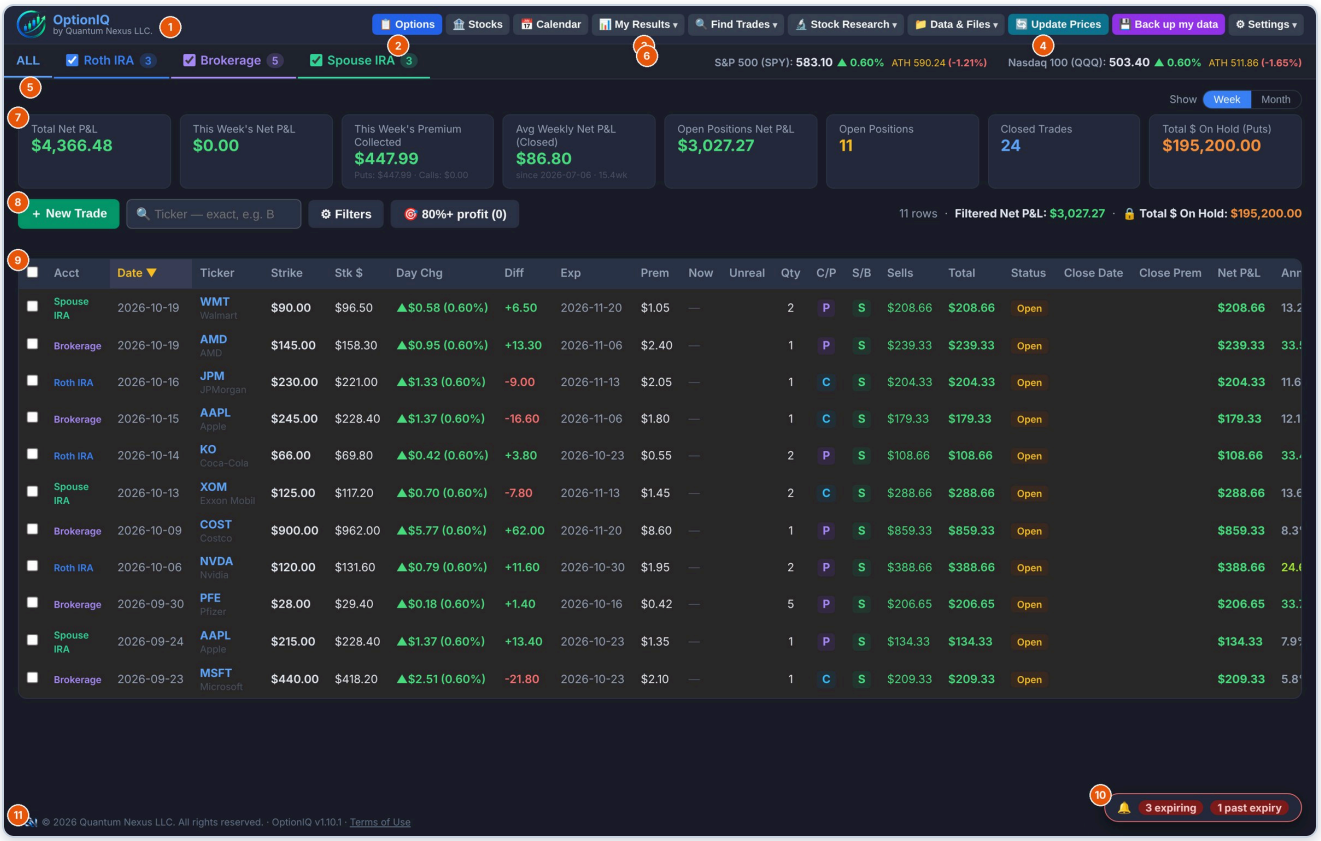
5. A tour of the main screen



The main screen, with the Options tab open

#	Part	What it is
1	OptionIQ logo	The app's name, by Quantum Nexus LLC.
2	Everyday buttons	📋 Options, 🏦 Stocks and 📅 Calendar. The screen you are on is lit up.
3	Menus	📊 My Results, 🔍 Find Trades, 🔬 Stock Research and 📁 Data & Files. Click one to see its choices.
4	Update Prices, Back up my data and Settings	Fresh prices, a backup right now, and ⚙️ Settings.
5	Account tabs	Choose which accounts to show.
6	Market indexes	Today's S&P 500 (SPY) and Nasdaq 100 (QQQ) prices and how far each is from its all-time high.
7	Summary cards	Your totals at a glance.
8	Toolbar	Add a trade, search, filter, and see totals for what is listed.
9	Trade list	Every trade that matches your filters.

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#	Part	What it is
10	🔔 Reminder button	Appears when options are expiring, past expiry, or a backup is due.
11	Footer	Copyright, the version you have, and the Terms of Use link.

The buttons along the top

The buttons along the top

The top bar keeps the buttons you use every day in view, and puts the rest in four menus. A heading with ▾ is a menu: click it to see its choices, then click one. Click anywhere else, or press **Esc**, to close a menu without choosing. When you are on a page from a menu, that menu's heading is lit up.

#	Button	What it does	More in
1	📋 Options	Your option trades.	Ch. 6
2	🏦 Stocks	The shares you own.	Ch. 7
3	📅 Calendar	Your open options on the day they expire.	Ch. 14
4	📊 My Results ▾	How your trading has gone: Analytics and Scorecard.	Ch. 8, 9
5	🔍 Find Trades ▾	New trades and rolls: Screen my Watchlist, Roll my options, Screen S&P 500.	Ch. 10, 12
6	🔬 Stock Research ▾	The stocks themselves: Stock Analysis, Edit my Watchlist, Watchlist facts.	Ch. 11, 13
7	📁 Data & Files ▾	Restore a backup, import trades, export to CSV or Excel.	Ch. 15
8	🔄 Update Prices	Fetches the latest stock and option prices, and tells you when SPY or QQQ reaches a new all-time high.	Ch. 15
9	💾 Back up my data	Makes a full backup right now.	Ch. 15
10	⚙️ Settings ▾	Settings (accounts, backups, reminders, cost per share, data folder, About) and your price key. Shows in red when no price key is saved.	Ch. 4, 17

What is in each menu

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Menu	Choice	What it opens	More in
📊 My Results	📈 Analytics	Open, in-the-money and closed trades, P&L by ticker, charts.	Ch. 8
	🏅 Scorecard	How each strategy, stock and account has really done.	Ch. 9
🔍 Find Trades	🎯 Screen my Watchlist	New puts and covered calls from your watchlist and shares. A small number shows how many results the last run found.	Ch. 10
	🔁 Roll my options	Later options to roll into, for ones close to expiry.	Ch. 10
	🔭 Screen S&P 500	Searches all 500 stocks for new names to watch.	Ch. 12
🔬 Stock Research	🔬 Stock Analysis	Buy / hold / trim view of every stock you hold or watch.	Ch. 11
	⭐ Edit my Watchlist	Add or remove tickers, and pick which ones the Screener checks.	Ch. 13
	👁️ Watchlist facts	A health card for each ticker on your watchlist.	Ch. 13
📁 Data & Files	📂 Restore from a backup	Brings back a backup made by 💾 Back up my data.	Ch. 15
	⬆ Import trades from a file	Your own spreadsheet, or the files you download from your broker (Fidelity for now).	Ch. 15
	⬇️ Export options to CSV	A plain list of your option trades.	Ch. 15
	📊 Excel report	A workbook with a sheet per account, weekly P&L and your stocks.	Ch. 15
⚙️ Settings	⚙️ Settings	Accounts, backups, reminders, cost per share, data folder and About.	Ch. 17
	🔑 Price key	Enter or change your Finnhub price key. Shows ✓ when a key is saved.	Ch. 4

The 🔍 Find Trades menu, open

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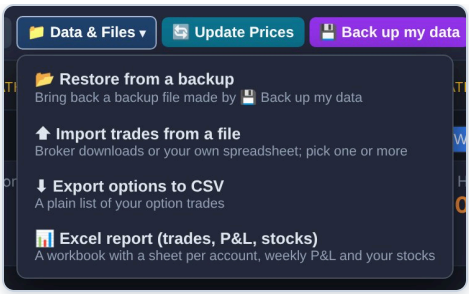
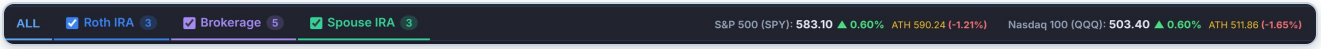


The 📁 Data & Files menu, open

Account tabs and market indexes



Account tabs on the left, market indexes on the right

Each account has a coloured tab with a tick box and a small number: how many open positions it has.

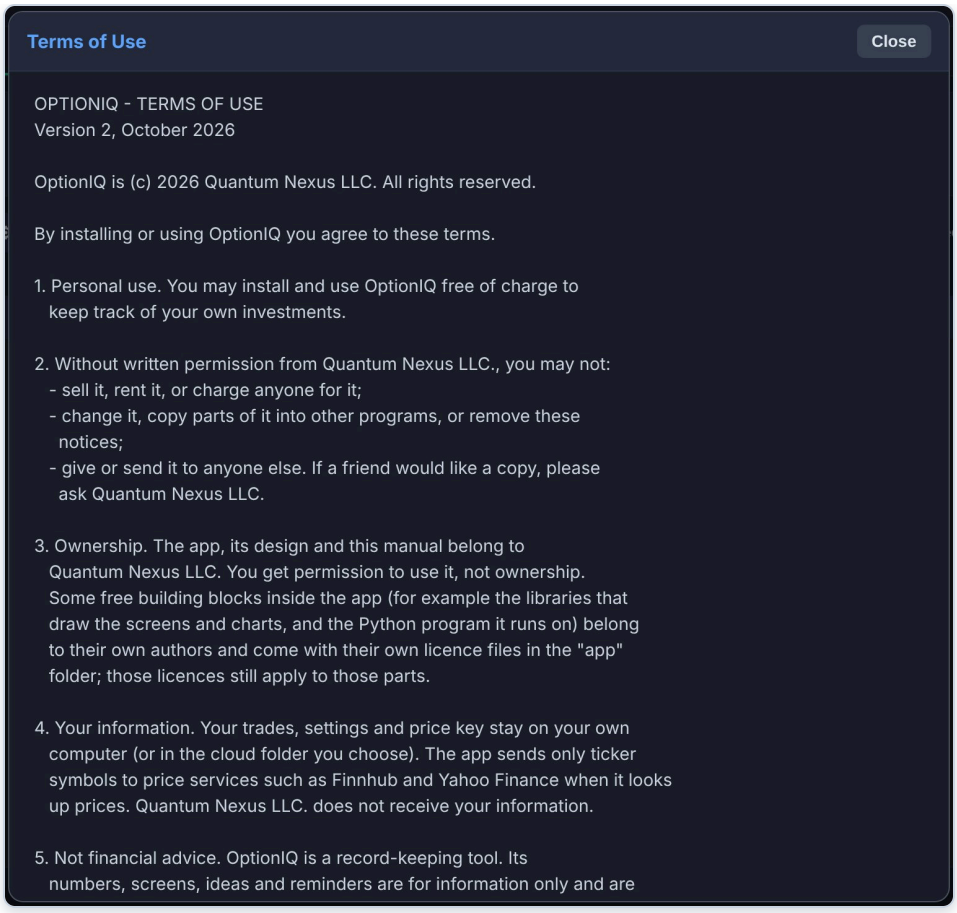
- **Untick** an account to hide its trades and leave them out of the totals. Tick it again to bring it back.
- Click **ALL** to show every account together.
- The choice applies to every tab: Options, Stocks, Analytics, Scorecard and the Calendar.

On the right, **S&P 500 (SPY)** and **Nasdaq 100 (QQQ)** show today's price and change, and **ATH**: the all-time high, with how far below it the index is now. The all-time highs are checked when the app starts and every time prices are updated; a 🎉 **New all-time high!** message appears next to the buttons when SPY or QQQ sets a new record.

The footer

The line at the bottom of every screen

The bottom line shows the copyright, the version number you have (for example **OptionIQ v1.9**) and a **Terms of Use** link that opens the full terms.



The Terms of Use window

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Part 2. The tabs, one by one

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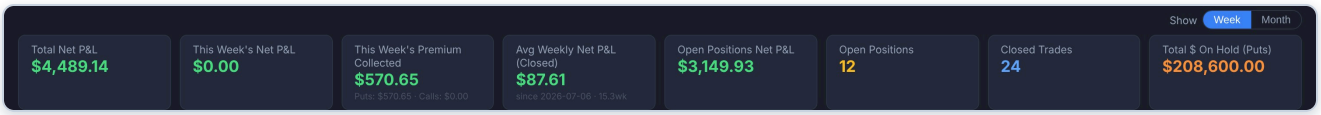
6. The Options tab

This is the screen you will use most. It lists your option trades and works out your profit.

Summary cards



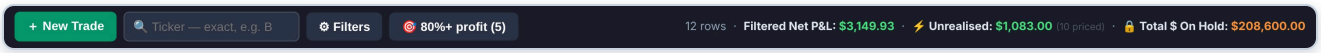
The eight summary cards, with the Week | Month switch above them

The small **Show Week | Month** switch above the cards changes three of them between this week (Monday to Friday) and this calendar month. OptionIQ remembers your choice.

Card	What it shows
Total Net P&L	All profit and loss, open and closed trades, after fees.
This Week's (or Month's) Net P&L	Profit from trades that closed this week, or this month.
This Week's (or Month's) Premium Collected	Premium from options you sold this week, or this month, split into Puts and Calls underneath.
Avg Weekly (or Monthly) Net P&L (Closed)	Average profit per week, or per month, from closed trades, since your first trade.
Premium Collected for Open Positions	The premium on the trades that are still open, after fees (an option you bought counts as a minus). Under it, from the option prices of 🔄 Prices: **Cost to close now** (what buying everything back would cost, with the $0.67 fee, minus what your bought options would sell for) and **If closed now** (the premium minus that cost, and the share of the premium you would keep). An option with no price yet is named on the last line with its premium, and left out of both lines.
Open Positions	How many trades are open.
Closed Trades	How many trades are closed.
Total $ On Hold (Puts)	Cash your broker sets aside for the puts you sold: strike × 100 × contracts.

The cards follow your account tabs: untick an account and its numbers leave the cards.

The toolbar



The Options toolbar

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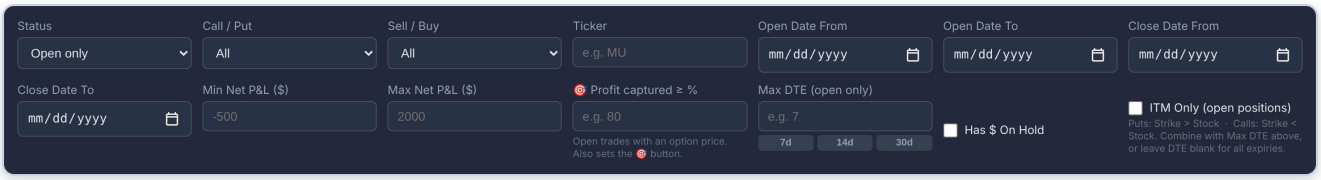
Part	What it does
+ New Trade	Opens a pop-up window to log a new trade (see below).
Search box	Type a ticker, for example `AAPL`, to show only that stock.
⚙️ **Filters**	Opens more ways to narrow the list. A small number shows how many filters are on, and **✕ Clear** turns them all off.
🎯 **80%+ profit (5)**	Shows only the open trades that have already captured at least 80% of their profit, so you can decide whether to close or roll them. The number in brackets counts them. Click again to show everything. The 80 is yours to change (see Filters below).
rows	How many trades are listed now.
Filtered Net P&L	Total profit of just the trades listed.
⚡ Unrealised	If you closed all listed open trades now, the profit you would keep. "(10 priced)" means 10 trades had a live option price.
💰 Money Required (Puts ITM)	Shows only when a sold put is in the money: the cash you would need if it were assigned.
🔒 Total $ On Hold	Cash set aside for the listed puts.

Filters



The Filters panel

Filter	What it does
Status	All, **Open only** (the normal choice) or Closed only.
Call/Put, Sell/Buy	Show only calls or puts, only options you sold or bought.
Ticker	Pick one stock.
Open Date From / To, Close Date From / To	Show trades opened or closed between two dates.
Min / Max Net P&L	Show only trades above or below an amount.
🎯 Profit captured ≥ %	Only open trades that have captured at least this much of their profit. Typing a number here also becomes the target of the 🎯 button, and OptionIQ remembers it.
Max DTE, with **7d**, **14d**, **30d**	Show only options expiring within that many days. DTE means days to expiry.
Has $ On Hold	Only puts that tie up cash.
ITM Only	Only options that are in the money now.

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> **Tip:** the filters stay as you left them until you click **✕ Clear**. If trades seem to be missing, check the filter count first.

How "profit captured" is worked out. It uses the option's price from 🔄 **Update Prices** (the **Now** column):

- **An option you sold:** the share of the premium you would keep if you bought it back now. Sold at $2.00 and now $0.10: you keep $1.90 of $2.00, so **95%** is captured.
- **An option you bought:** the gain on what you paid. Bought at $2.00 and now $3.00: **50%** gain.

Trades without an option price are left out, so click 🔄 **Update Prices** first.

The trade list

Each row is one trade. Click a column heading to sort by it; click again to reverse the order.

Column	Meaning
☐	Tick to select a row (see "Deleting several trades" below).
Acct	The account, in its colour.
Date	The day you opened the trade.
Ticker	The stock. Click it to open a price chart, with a link to **Open in Yahoo Finance ↗**.
Strike	The strike price.
Stk $	The latest stock price (after 🔄 Update Prices).
Day Chg	Today's change in the stock price, in dollars and percent.
Diff	Stock price minus strike. For a sold put, a positive number is good (the stock is above the strike).
Exp	The expiry date.
Prem	The premium per share when you opened it.
Now	Today's option price per share. `*` means the middle of bid and ask; ⌛ means the price is old. "⌛ expired — still open" means the expiry date has passed but you haven't closed the trade yet.
Unreal	Profit you would keep if you closed now, with the percent of the premium already earned.
Qty	Number of contracts.
C/P, S/B	Call or Put; Sold or Bought.
Sells, Total	The premium in dollars after the fee.
Status	Open or Closed.
Close Date, Close Prem	When and for how much it was closed.

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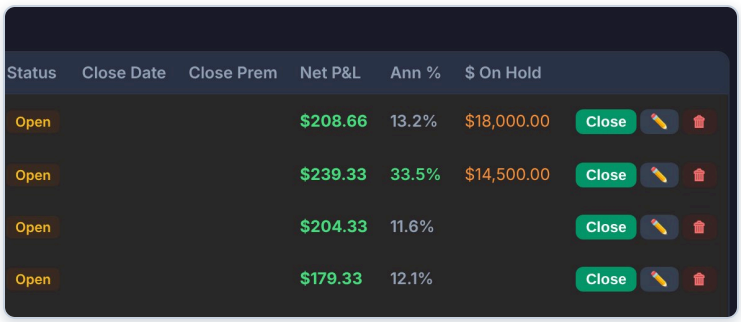
Column	Meaning
Net P&L	The profit or loss of the trade.
Ann %	Yearly rate of return for the trade. Hover for how it was worked out.
$ On Hold	Cash set aside for this put.

Row buttons



At the right end of each row: Close, edit and delete

Button	What it does
Close	Opens the Close / Roll window for an open trade (see below). Closed trades don't have it.
✂️	Only on open trades with 2 or more contracts. Splits the trade into two trades (see below).
✏️	Opens the Edit Trade pop-up for this trade.
🗑️	Delete this trade. The app asks first.

When you click ✏️, the **Edit Trade** window opens in the middle of the screen. It has the same large boxes as New Trade, filled in with the trade's current values, plus **Close Date** and **Close price per share**. For a closed trade, the close price box shows the price per share worked out from the saved total; type a new price to change it, and the small line under the box shows the dollar total that will be saved. The line under the boxes shows the **Sells** and **Net P&L** as you type. Change what you need, then click **Save Changes**, or **Cancel** to close without changing anything.

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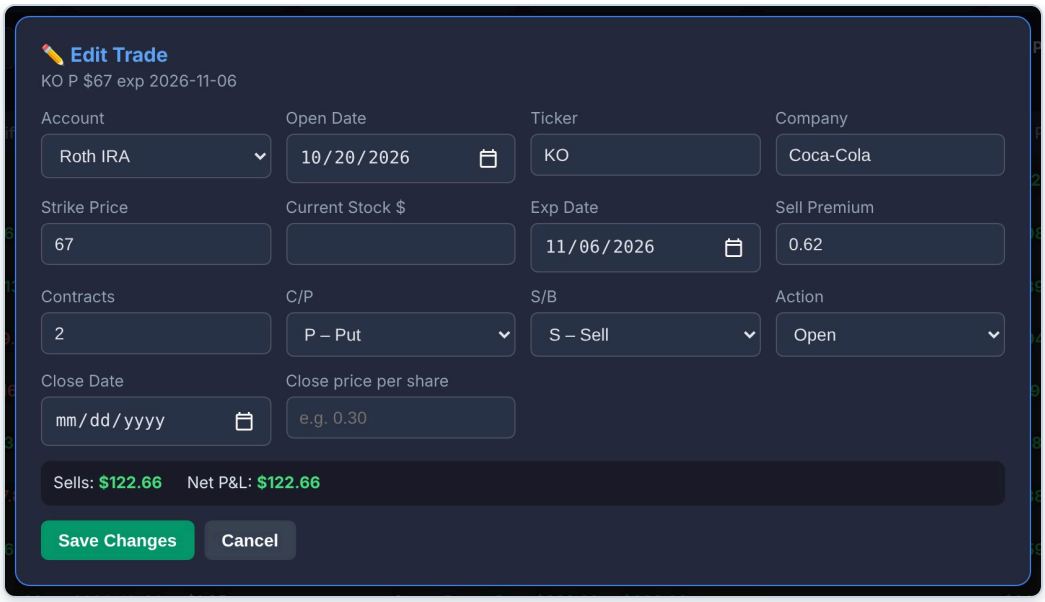

The Edit Trade window

> **Tip:** to close or roll a trade, use the **Close** button instead. It works out the numbers and moves shares for you. If you do change **Action** to Assigned or Called Away here, the shares are moved the same way.

Logging a new trade

Click **+ New Trade**. The New Trade window opens in the middle of the screen, over the list, so you can see it however far down you have scrolled. Fill in the boxes and click **Add Trade**, or **Cancel** to close it.

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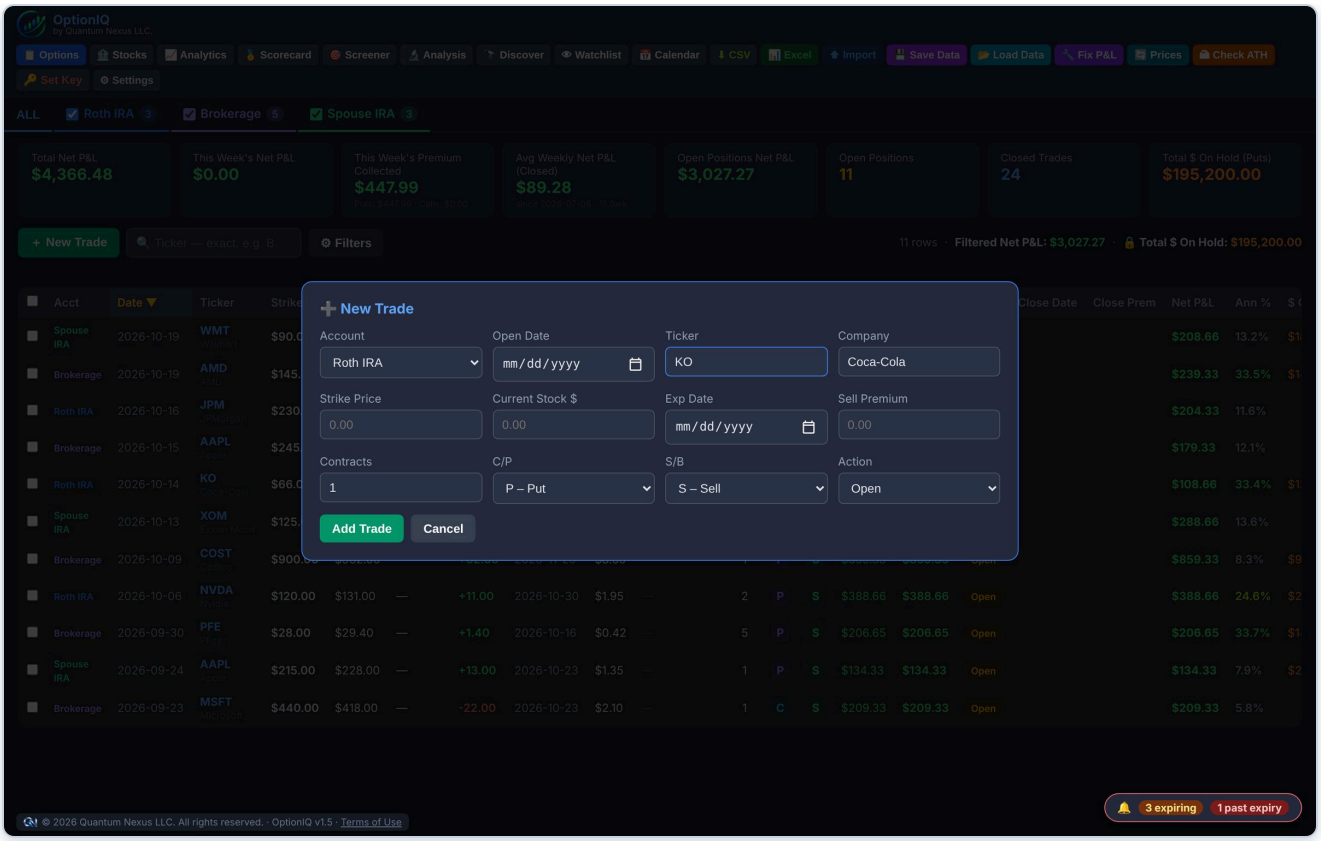
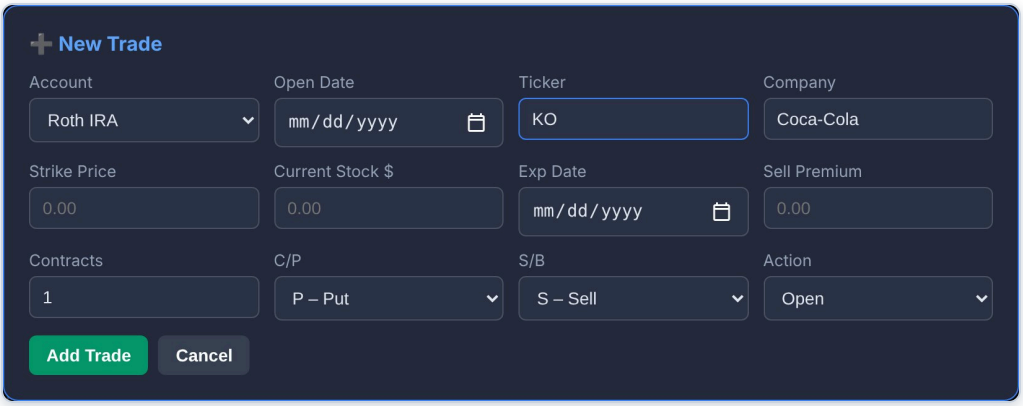


The New Trade window opens over the list



The New Trade form

Box	What to enter
Account	Which account the trade is in.
Open Date	The day you opened it. It starts on today's date; change it if you traded on another day.
Ticker	The stock symbol, for example KO.
Company	Filled in for you from the ticker.
Strike Price	The strike.
Current Stock $	The stock price when you traded (optional).

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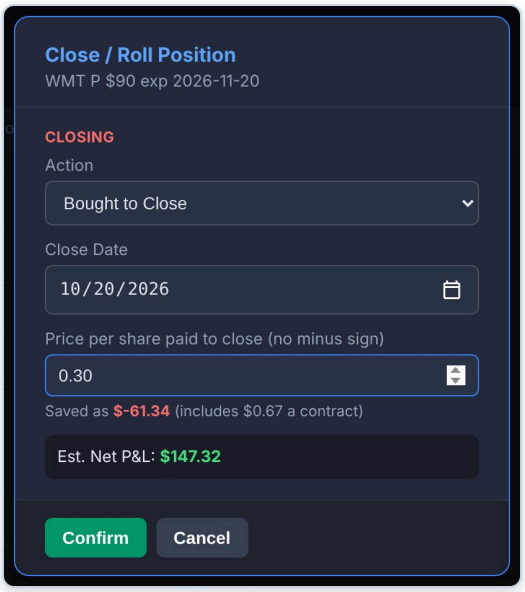
Box	What to enter
Exp Date	The expiry date.
Sell Premium	The premium per share.
Contracts	How many contracts.
C/P	Call or Put.
S/B	Sell (you received the premium) or Buy (you paid it).
Action	Leave as **Open** for a new trade.

The line under the form shows what the trade collects (**Sells**) and, for a put, the cash it puts **On Hold**. Click **Add Trade** to save it, or **Cancel**.

Closing or rolling a trade



The Close / Roll window

Click **Close** on an open trade. Choose what happened in **Action**:

Action	When to use it
Expired	The option ran out worthless. You keep the whole premium.
Assigned	Your sold put was exercised and you bought the shares. The app adds the shares to 🏦 Stocks for you (100 × contracts, at the strike price).
Called Away	Your covered call was exercised and your shares were sold. The app asks, then sells the shares from your oldest lot.
Bought to Close	You bought the option back before expiry.
Sold to Close	You sold an option you had bought.

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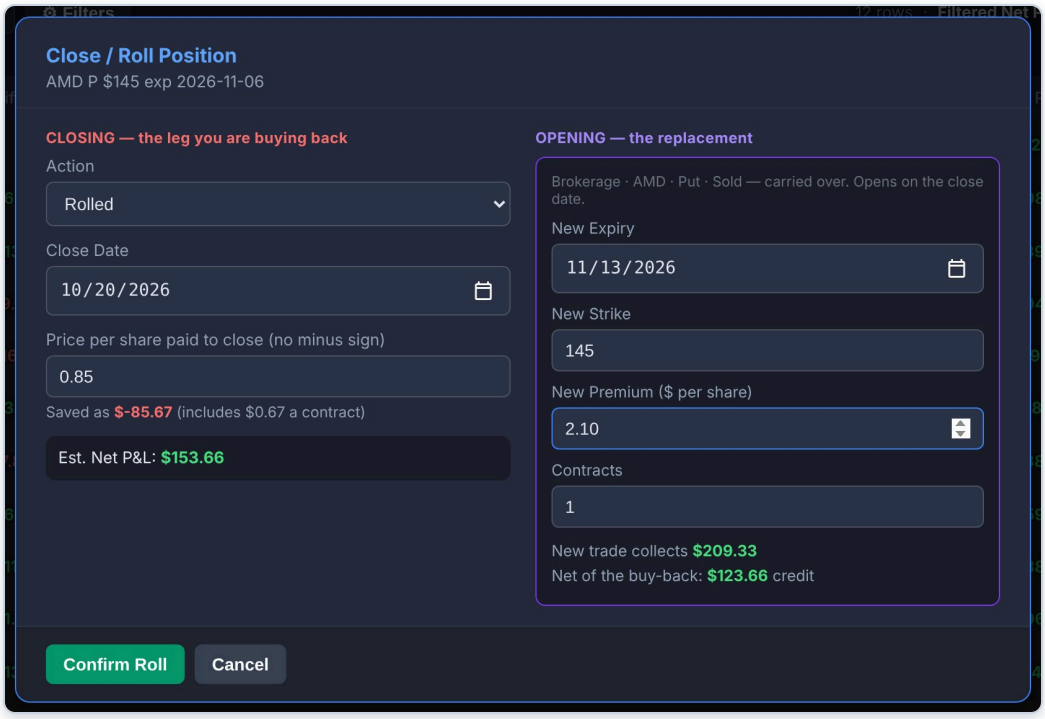
Action	When to use it
Rolled	You bought it back and sold a new one on the same stock.

Fill in **Close Date** (it starts on today's date) and the **price per share**, the same way you type the premium for a new trade. Type it as a plain number, for example `0.30`, with **no minus sign**; the minus key does nothing in this box.

- For an option you **sold** (most trades), the box says **Price per share paid to close**. Buying it back costs money, so the app saves the total as a negative amount: price × contracts × 100, plus $0.67 a contract. For example, 0.30 on 2 contracts is saved as **-$61.34**.
- For an option you **bought**, the box says **Price per share received**. The app saves price × contracts × 100, less $0.67 a contract, as a positive amount.

The line under the box shows exactly what will be saved (**Saved as ...**). Leave the box empty for Expired, Assigned and Called Away. **Est. Net P&L** shows the result. Click **Confirm** to save, or **Cancel**. The Options list, reports and exports still show the dollar totals, and trades closed before version 1.6 are not changed.

When you choose **Rolled**, a second part opens on the right: **OPENING — the replacement**. Fill in the **New Expiry**, **New Strike**, **New Premium** and **Contracts**. The window shows what the new trade collects and the **Net of the buy-back** (a credit is good). Click **Confirm Roll**. The old trade is closed, the new one is logged, and the two are linked so the 🏅 Scorecard can show the whole roll as one chain.



Rolling: the replacement trade on the right

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> **Careful:** for a **call** that was assigned, choose **Called Away**, not Assigned. If a call is marked Assigned, the app reminds you to sell the shares yourself on 🏦 Stocks → Sell.

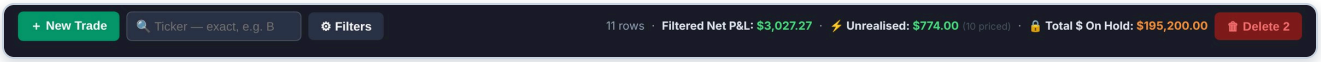
Splitting a trade (roll some contracts, keep the rest)

Sometimes you want to treat the contracts of one trade differently. For example, you sold 2 puts and want to roll 1 and let the other be assigned.

The quick way: click **Close**, and in **Contracts to close** type how many you are closing or rolling (for example 1 of 2). The window works out the buy-back, the Net P&L and the **Net of the buy-back** for just those contracts. When you confirm, the others stay open as their own trade.

Or split first: click the yellow ✂️ button next to **Close**, and type how many contracts go into the new trade (for 2 contracts, type 1). OptionIQ splits it into two trades with the same stock, strike, expiry and premium per share; the money (Sells, Total, Net P&L, $ On Hold) is shared out by contracts. Now close, roll or mark each one on its own.

Deleting several trades



Tick rows and a red Delete button appears

Tick the box at the start of several rows. A red 🗑️ **Delete N** button appears in the toolbar. Click it to delete them all (the app asks first). **Careful:** deleting can't be undone, so press 💾 Back up my data first.

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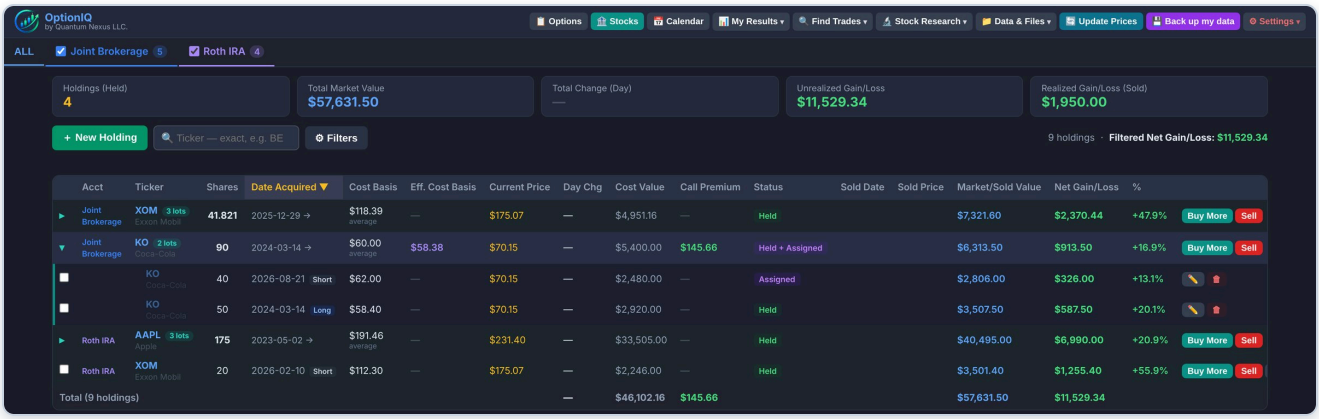
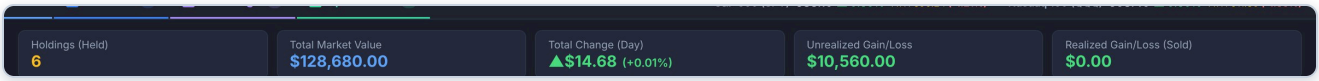
7. The Stocks tab



The Stocks tab

This tab lists the shares you own in each account, and shares you have sold.

Summary cards

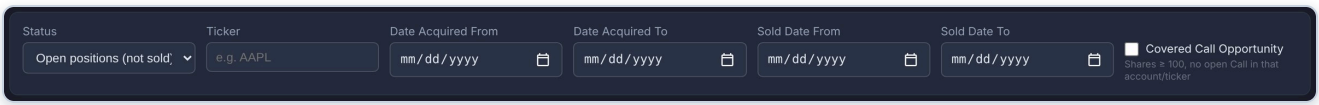


The Stocks summary cards

Card	What it shows
Holdings (Held)	How many stocks you still own. A stock bought in several lots in one account counts once.
Total Market Value	What they are worth at today's prices.
Total Change (Day)	How much their value moved today.
Unrealized Gain/Loss	Gain or loss on shares you still own.
Realized Gain/Loss (Sold)	Gain or loss on shares you have sold.

Toolbar and filters

The toolbar has **+ New Holding**, a search box, ⚙️ **Filters**, the number of holdings listed, and **Filtered Net Gain/Loss**. When you tick rows, a red 🗑️ **Delete N** button appears, just as on the Options tab.



The Stocks filters

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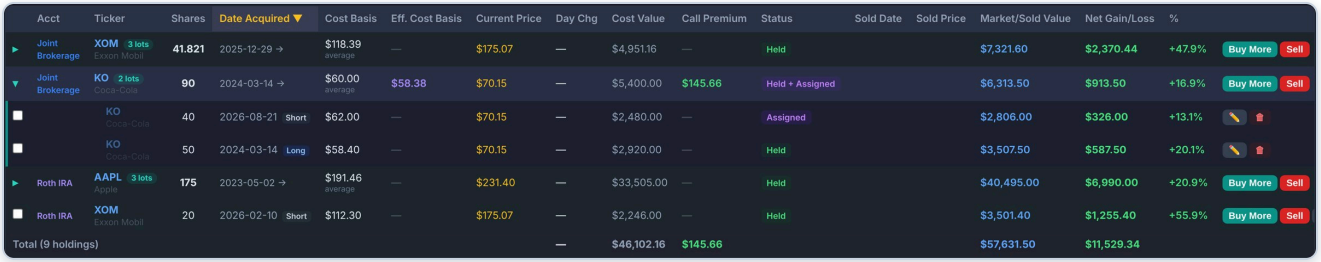
Filter	What it does
Status	All, Open positions (not sold), Held only, Assigned only, or Sold only.
Ticker	Pick one stock.
Date Acquired From / To, Sold Date From / To	Narrow by date.
Covered Call Opportunity	Shows only holdings with at least 100 shares and no open call on them: shares you could sell a covered call on.

The holdings list

Column	Meaning
Shares, Date Acquired	How many shares and when you got them.
Cost Basis	What you paid per share.
Eff. Cost Basis	The stock's average cost after subtracting the call premium you collected on it.
Current Price, Day Chg	Today's price and change.
Cost Value	Shares × cost basis.
Call Premium	The premium from calls sold on the stock since its oldest lot you still hold (or since its first assignment, if that came earlier). Stocks you bought yourself count once you hold 100 or more shares. It is shown once, on the stock's line, and stays there when you sell some of the lots.
Status	Held, Assigned (from a put) or Sold. A stock with both kinds of lots shows **Held + Assigned**.
Sold Date, Sold Price	For sold shares.
Market/Sold Value	Value now, or what you sold for.
Net Gain/Loss, %	Your gain or loss in dollars and percent.

Stocks bought in several lots



KO bought in two lots: the stock line (▾ opened) and its lots underneath

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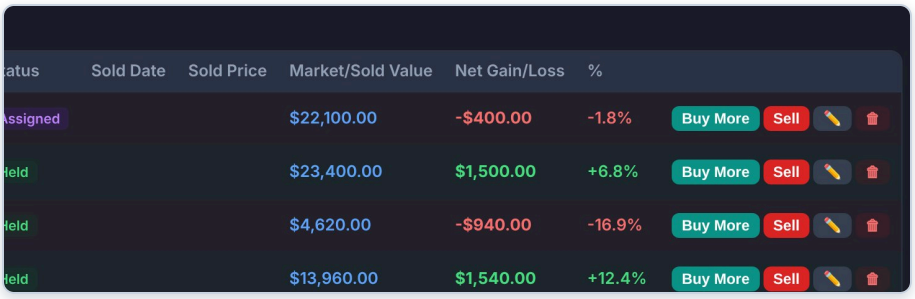
Each purchase of a stock is a **lot**: the shares you bought on one day at one price. Shares from an assigned put, and the small amounts bought with reinvested dividends, are lots too. When you hold a stock in more than one lot in the same account, OptionIQ shows it the way your broker does:

- **One line for the stock**, with the total shares, the average cost (marked "average"), the call premium and effective cost, and a pill such as **2 lots**. Its date is the oldest lot's date, with an arrow.
- Click the line (or ▸) to open it. The **lots** appear underneath, newest first, slightly indented. Each one shows its own date, shares, cost per share, value and gain.
- Next to each lot's date, **Short** or **Long** says whether you have held it for a year or less (short-term) or more than a year (long-term). This matters for taxes when you sell.
- A lot marked **earlier shares** holds shares from before the dates in your broker files (see Chapter 15), so OptionIQ doesn't know when each was bought.
- **Buy More** and **Sell** are on the stock's line; ✏️ and 🗑️ are on each lot.

A stock with only one lot shows as a single line, as before.



Row buttons: Buy More, Sell, edit and delete

Button	What it does
Buy More	Add shares you bought. They are saved as a **new lot** with their own date and cost, so each purchase keeps its own history. The window shows the **New Total Shares** and the **New Average Cost Basis**.
Sell	Sell some or all shares. With several lots you choose which lots are sold (see below). The window shows the **Realized Gain/Loss** and how many remain held.
✏️ / 🗑️	✏️ opens the Edit Holding pop-up; 🗑️ deletes the holding.

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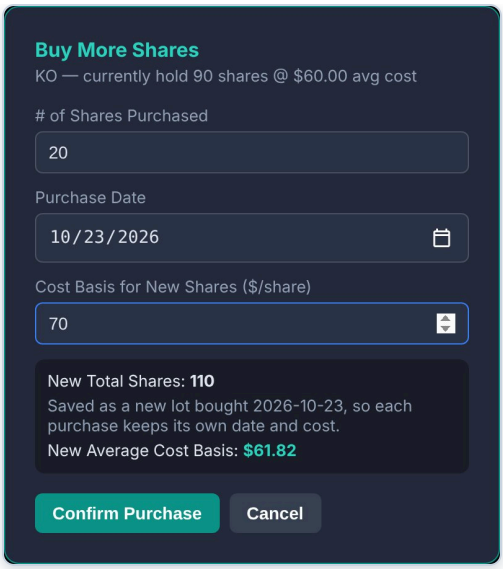
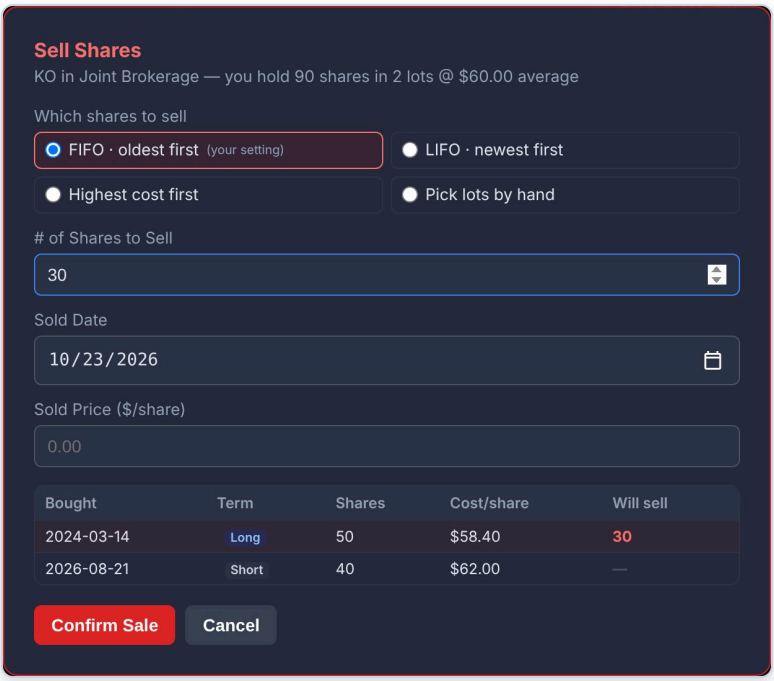


Buy More Shares window: the new shares become their own lot

Which lots are sold: FIFO, LIFO, Highest cost or by hand



Sell Shares window: pick the method; the table shows which lots will be sold

When a stock has more than one lot, the **Sell Shares** window asks **Which shares to sell**:

Choice	Which shares go first
FIFO · oldest first	The lots you bought first. This is what most brokers do unless you ask otherwise.
LIFO · newest first	The lots you bought last.
Highest cost first	The lots that cost the most, which usually means the smallest taxable gain.

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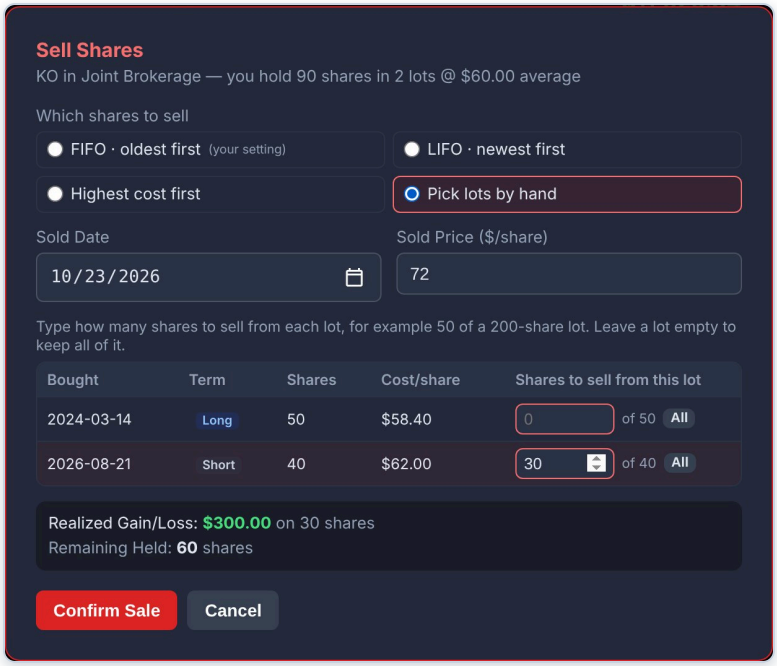
Choice	Which shares go first
Pick lots by hand	You type how many shares to sell from each lot.

The choice marked **(your setting)** is the one set for that account in ⚙️ Settings → Selling shares (Chapter 17). You can pick a different one for this sale only. The table underneath shows each lot, whether it is Short or Long term, and **Will sell**: how many shares come from each lot.



Pick lots by hand: type how many shares to sell from each lot

With **Pick lots by hand**, type the shares to sell in each lot's box. You can sell part of a lot, for example 50 of a 200-share lot; **All** fills in the whole lot. Leave a box empty to keep that lot.

Sold lots move to the sold list (Status filter **Sold only**), each with its own gain or loss, its term, and the method used.

When a covered call is called away, OptionIQ uses the account's setting to choose which lots go. A message lists the lots first: **OK** uses them, and **Cancel** lets you pick FIFO, LIFO or Highest cost instead.

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Adding a holding

The New Stock Holding form

Click **+ New Holding**. A pop-up window opens in the middle of the screen. Fill in the **Account**, **Ticker** (the company name fills in), **# of Shares**, **Date Acquired**, **Cost Basis** per share, **Current Price** (optional; 🔄 Update Prices fills it in) and **Status** (Held, Assigned (from Put) or Sold). Click **Add Holding** to save, or **Cancel** to close it.

> **Tip:** shares you get from an assigned put are added for you when you close the put as **Assigned**. You don't need to add them by hand.

Editing a holding

Click ✏️ at the end of a holding's row. The **Edit Holding** window opens with the holding's current values in large boxes, and shows the cost value, market value and gain or loss as you type. Change what you need and click **Save Changes**, or **Cancel**.

The Edit Holding window

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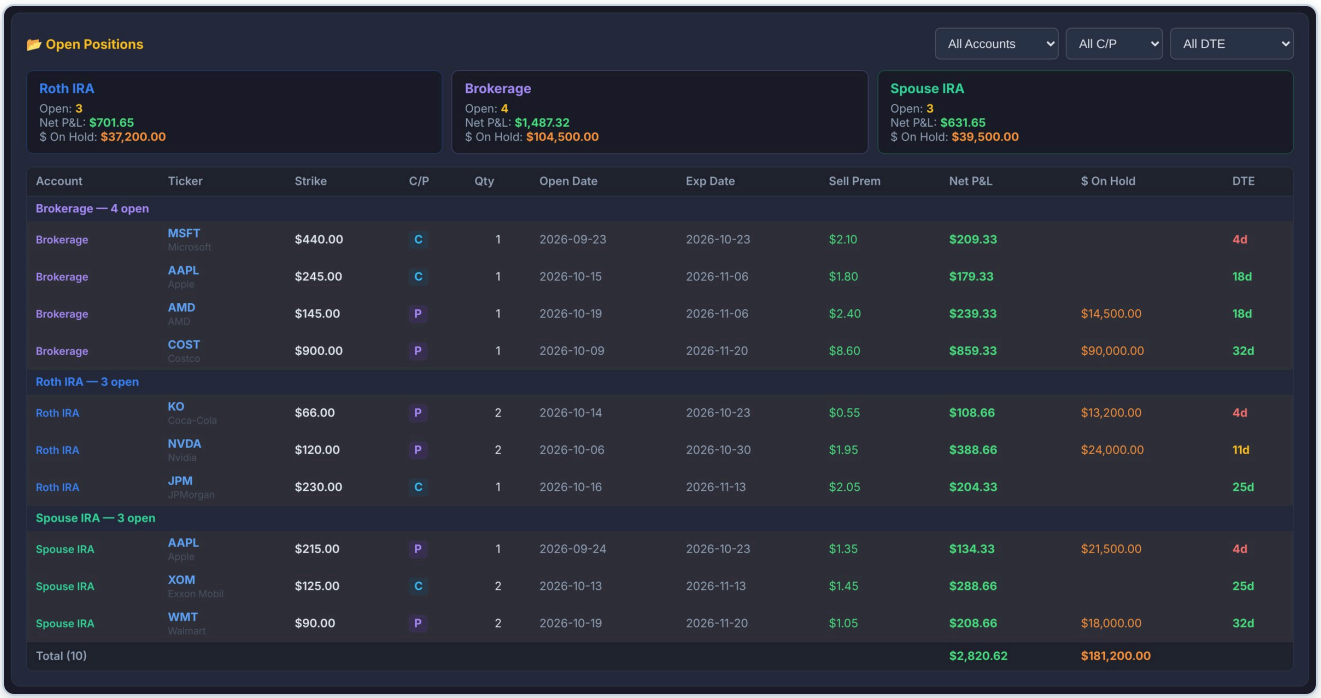
8. Analytics

Open it from 📊 **My Results** → 📈 **Analytics**. Analytics shows your trading in tables and charts. Every part follows the account tabs at the top.

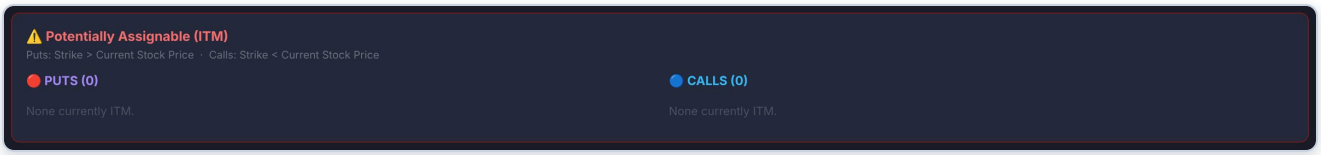
Open positions



Open Positions, grouped by account

Use the drop-downs at the top right to show **All Accounts** or one, **All C/P** or only calls or puts, and **All DTE** or only options expiring within 7, 14 or 30 days. Each account card shows how many trades are open, their Net P&L and the cash on hold. The table groups open trades by account, with **DTE** (days to expiry) in the last column: red when it is very close.

Potentially assignable (in the money)



Puts and calls that are in the money

This box lists sold **puts** whose stock is now below the strike, and sold **calls** whose stock is above the strike. These could be assigned. "None currently ITM" means nothing is at risk right now.

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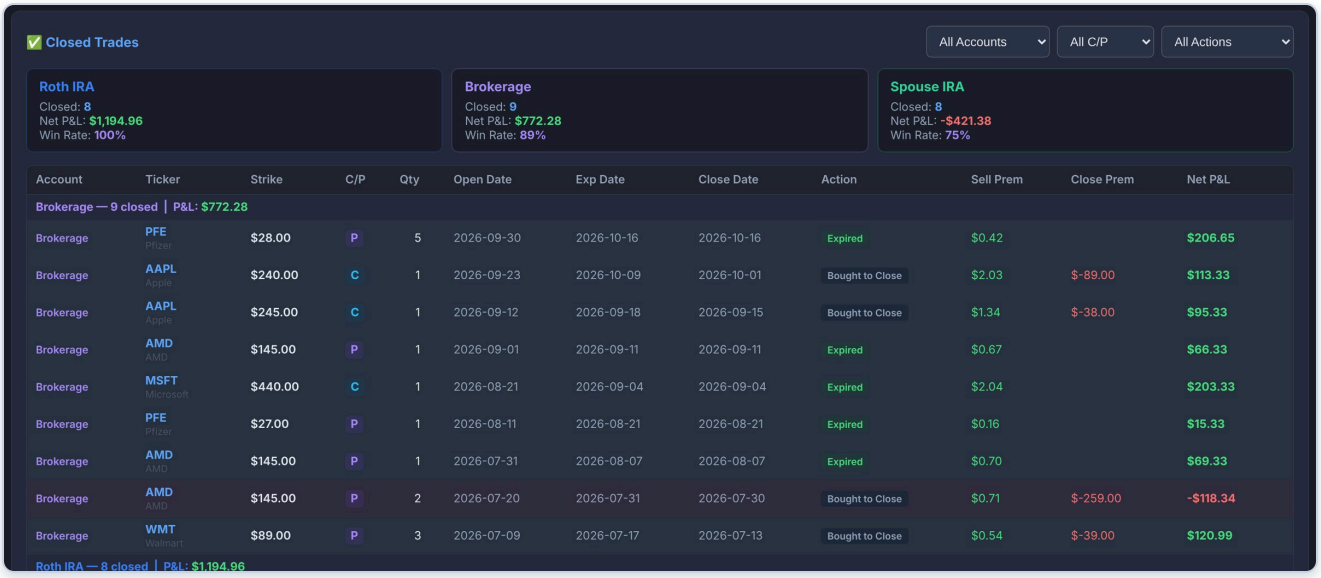
Closed trades



Closed trades, with a win rate per account

Filter by account, call/put and **Action** (Expired, Bought to Close, and so on). Each account card shows the number of closed trades, Net P&L and **Win Rate**: the percent of closed trades that made money. Losing trades are tinted red.

Charts

P&L by Ticker

P&L by Ticker shows total profit for each stock, best first. Red bars are losses.

P&L by Month

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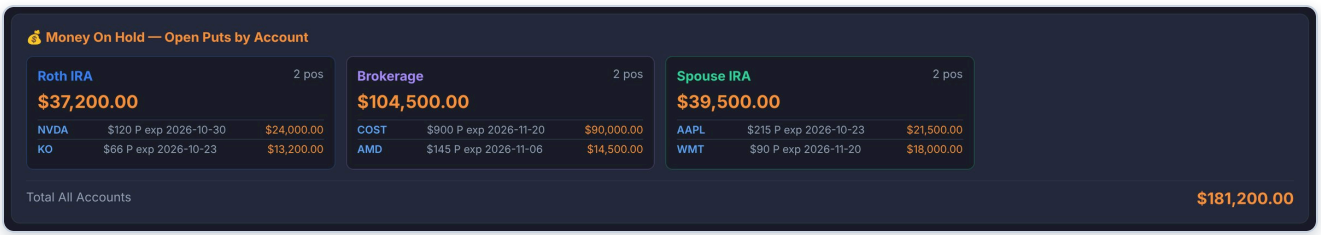
P&L by Month shows profit for each calendar month.

P&L by Week, with a running total line

P&L by Week shows a green or red bar for each week (closed trades, by the Friday of that week) and an orange line for the running total.



Money On Hold, open puts by account

Money On Hold shows the cash set aside for open puts in each account, the puts that make it up, and the total.

Weekly Premium Collected, Puts vs Calls, and Premium by Account

Weekly Premium Collected shows the premium you received each week from puts (purple) and calls (blue). **Premium Collected by Account** totals it for each account since you started.

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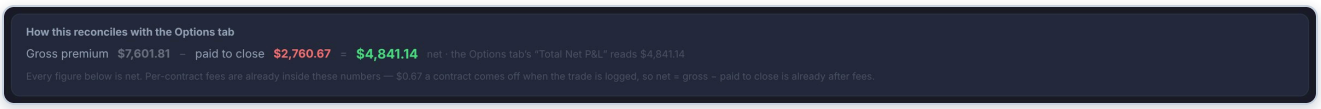
9. Scorecard

Open it from 📊 **My Results** → 🏅 **Scorecard**. The Scorecard answers "how well is this really working?" It looks at the money you put at risk and how long it was at risk, not just the dollars you kept.

Headline cards

The four headline numbers

Card	Meaning
Annualized on capital at risk	Your net premium as a yearly rate on the money at risk, weighted by how long it was at risk.
Net premium kept	Premium received minus what you paid to close.
Gross premium	All premium received.
Period	From your first trade to today.



How the Scorecard ties back to the Options tab

How this reconciles with the Options tab shows the sum: gross premium minus what you paid to close equals net, which matches the Options tab's Total Net P&L.

Rolled vs. left alone

Rolls are counted as one chain from first open to final close

A roll chain is treated as one campaign: every credit and buy-back across all its legs, from the first open to the final close. The two boxes compare trades you **rolled** with trades you **left alone**, and the table lists each chain. Chains are linked only when you roll with the **Rolled** action in the Close window.

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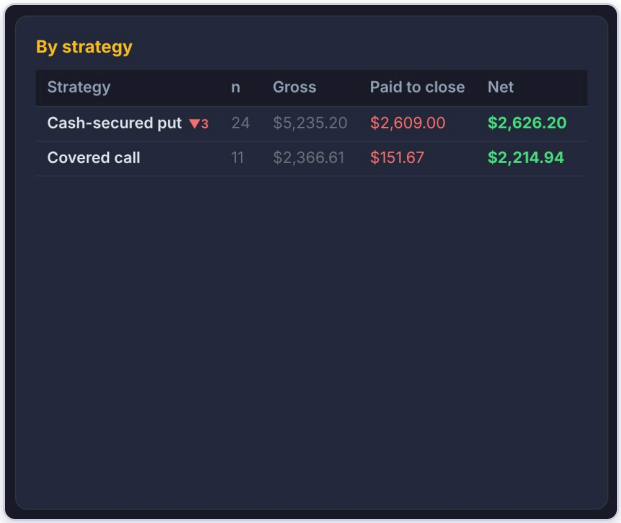
By strategy, underlying and account

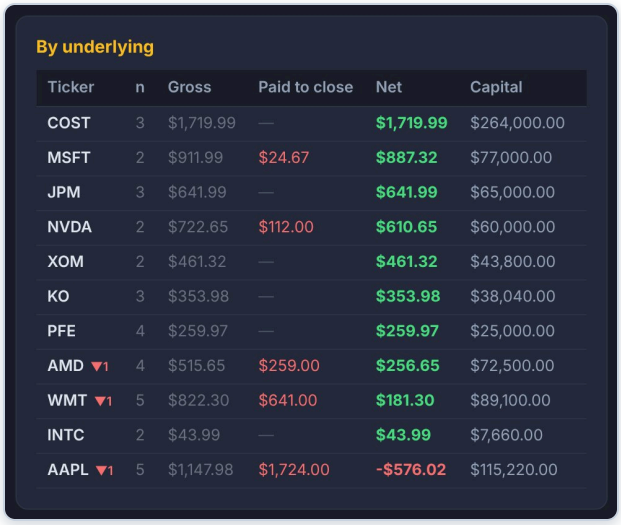


By strategy

Strategy	n	Gross	Paid to close	Net
Cash-secured put ▼3	24	$5,235.20	$2,609.00	$2,626.20
Covered call	11	$2,366.61	$151.67	$2,214.94

Results by strategy, by stock, and by account

Three tables split results by **strategy** (cash-secured put, covered call), by **underlying** stock and by **account**. A small red ▼ with a number shows how many losing trades are in that row. **Capital** is the money that was at risk.



By underlying

Ticker	n	Gross	Paid to close	Net	Capital
COST	3	$1,719.99	—	$1,719.99	$264,000.00
MSFT	2	$911.99	$24.67	$887.32	$77,000.00
JPM	3	$641.99	—	$641.99	$65,000.00
NVDA	2	$722.65	$112.00	$610.65	$60,000.00
XOM	2	$461.32	—	$461.32	$43,800.00
KO	3	$353.98	—	$353.98	$38,040.00
PFE	4	$259.97	—	$259.97	$25,000.00
AMD ▼1	4	$515.65	$259.00	$256.65	$72,500.00
WMT ▼1	5	$822.30	$641.00	$181.30	$89,100.00
INTC	2	$43.99	—	$43.99	$7,660.00
AAPL ▼1	5	$1,147.98	$1,724.00	-$576.02	$115,220.00

By underlying

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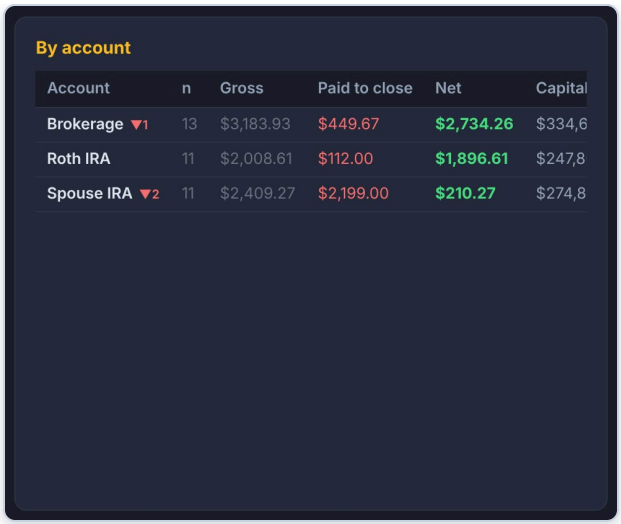
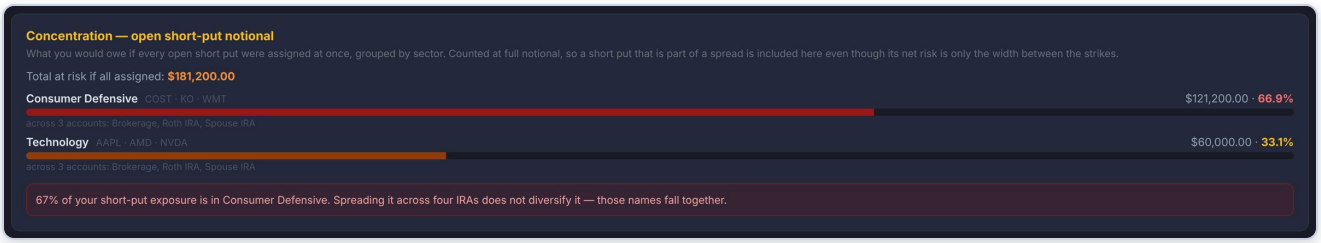


By account

Concentration



How much of your put risk sits in each sector

If every open put were assigned at once, how much stock would you have to buy, and in which sectors? A red warning appears when too much sits in one sector. Sectors come from 🔬 Stock Research → Stock Analysis, so run it once first; until then everything shows as Unclassified.

Against simply holding the index

Your return compared with SPY and QQQ

Click 📊 **Fetch SPY / QQQ** (later 🔄 **Refresh**) to compare your yearly return with simply owning the S&P 500 (SPY) or Nasdaq 100 (QQQ) over the same dates. It needs the Screener service.

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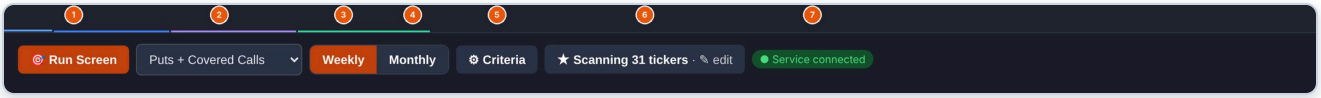
10. Screen my Watchlist and Roll my options

Open the Screener from 🔍 **Find Trades** → 🎯 **Screen my Watchlist**. It looks for new trades to place: **cash-secured puts** on the stocks in your watchlist, and **covered calls** on shares you hold. Its partner page, 🔍 **Find Trades** → 🔁 **Roll my options**, suggests **rolls** for options you already have (at the end of this chapter). It uses free Yahoo Finance data, so it needs no key, but it needs the internet and the one-time download from Chapter 2.

The Screener bar

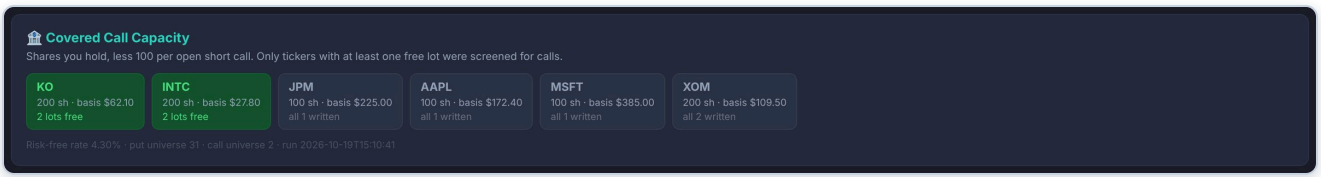


The Screener bar

#	Button	What it does
1	🎯 Run Screen	Checks every ticker on your watchlist and lists the contracts that pass your rules. Takes from a few seconds to a minute.
2	Side	**Puts + Covered Calls**, **Cash-Secured Puts only** or **Covered Calls only**.
3	Weekly	Fills in rules for short trades: 4 to 14 days, delta 0.10 to 0.25, at least $40 per contract.
4	Monthly	Fills in rules for longer trades: 21 to 45 days, delta 0.15 to 0.30, at least $75 per contract. If you change any rule, neither button is lit ("Custom").
5	⚙️ Criteria	Opens all the rules (below).
6	★ Scanning 31 tickers · ✎ edit	How many tickers the next run checks. Click it to open ⭐ Edit my Watchlist (Chapter 13).
7	Service connected	Green means the Screener's helper is running. If it is red, click ↻ **Retry**, or close and reopen the app.

After a run, three more appear: a results filter (**All results**, **Puts only** or **Calls only**), how many contracts are listed, and **✕ Clear**, which clears the results.

Covered Call Capacity



Covered Call Capacity: which holdings have shares free for a call

Each card is a stock you hold. Green cards have at least one free lot of 100 shares that is not already covered by a call, so the Screener looks for calls on them. Grey cards say why not: "all 1

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written" (every lot already has a call) or "under 100 sh".

The results

Screened contracts, best score first

Each row is one option contract you could sell. The list is sorted by **Score**, best first.

Column	Meaning
Score	0 to 100. Hover over it to see why (below).
Ticker and flags	⚠ earnings before expiry; 💲 a dividend before expiry; ⚖️ you already have a lot in this sector; ⛰ the strike sits near a price level the stock has bounced off before.
Side	PUT or CALL.
Expiry, DTE	Expiry date and days to expiry.
Strike, Spot	Strike price and today's stock price.
Day $, Day %	Today's stock move.
OTM%	How far the strike is from today's price. Bigger means safer, but less premium.
Prem, Net $	Premium per share, and dollars per contract after the $0.67 fee.
Ann %	Yearly rate of return if it expires worthless.
IV, IV/HV, IVR	How richly the option is priced: implied volatility, compared with how much the stock has actually moved, and with its own past year (IV Rank). IVR needs about 60 days of history, which the app collects by itself while it is open; until then it shows how many days it has.
Δ	Delta: roughly the chance the option ends in the money. 0.20 is about a 1-in-5 chance.
PoP	Probability of profit.
OI, Spr%	Open interest and bid/ask spread: how easy it is to trade.
P/E	Price to earnings ratio of the stock.

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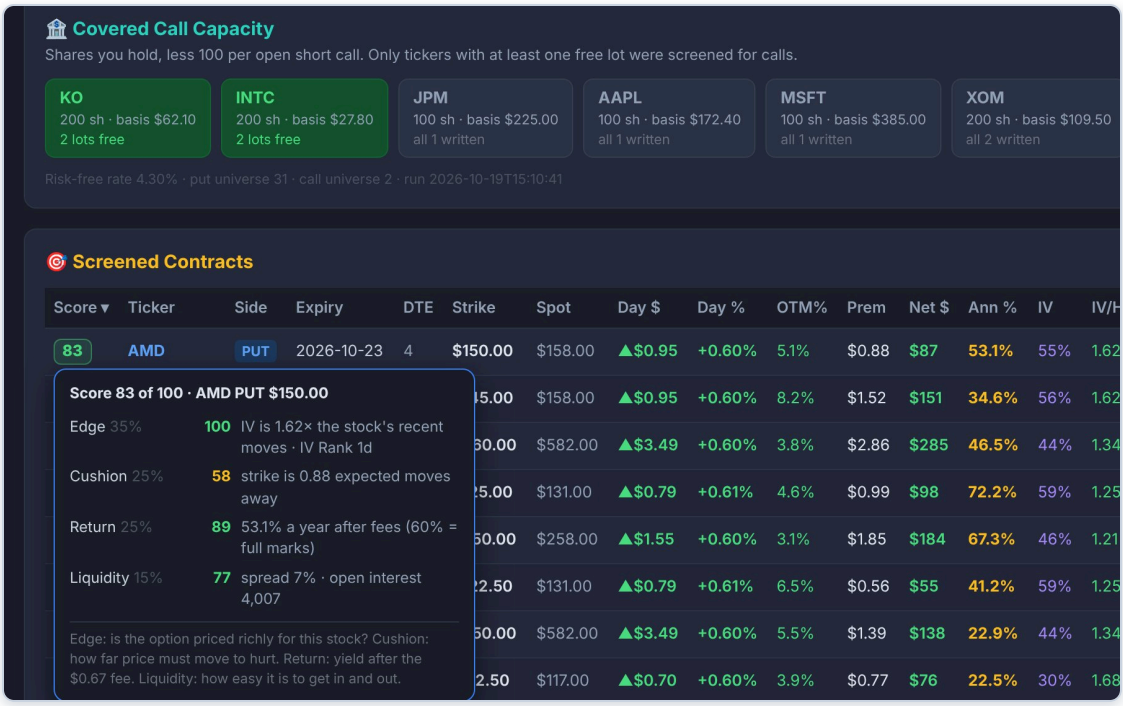
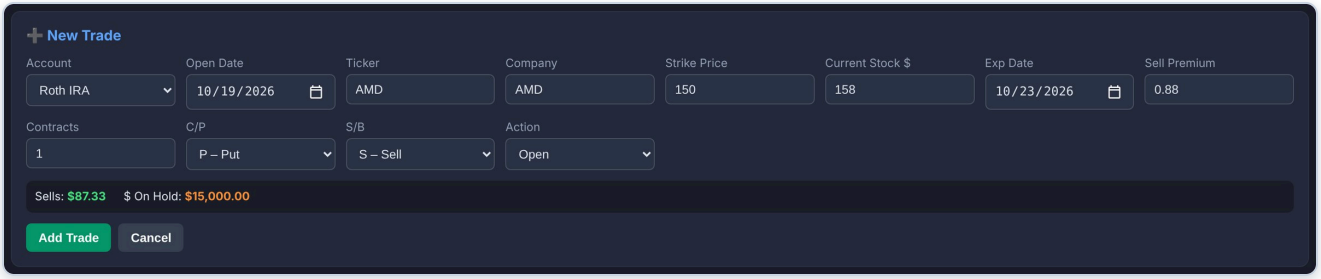
Column	Meaning
Free, Basis, vs Basis	For covered calls: free lots, your cost basis, and how far the strike is above it.
B/E	Break-even price.
+ Log	Opens the New Trade window on the Options tab, already filled in. Check it and click **Add Trade**.



Hover over a Score to see how it was worked out

The Score adds up four things: **Edge** (35%): is the option priced richly for this stock; **Cushion** (25%): how far the price must move before it hurts; **Return** (25%): the yearly return after the fee; and **Liquidity** (15%): how easy it is to get in and out.



+ Log fills in the New Trade window for you

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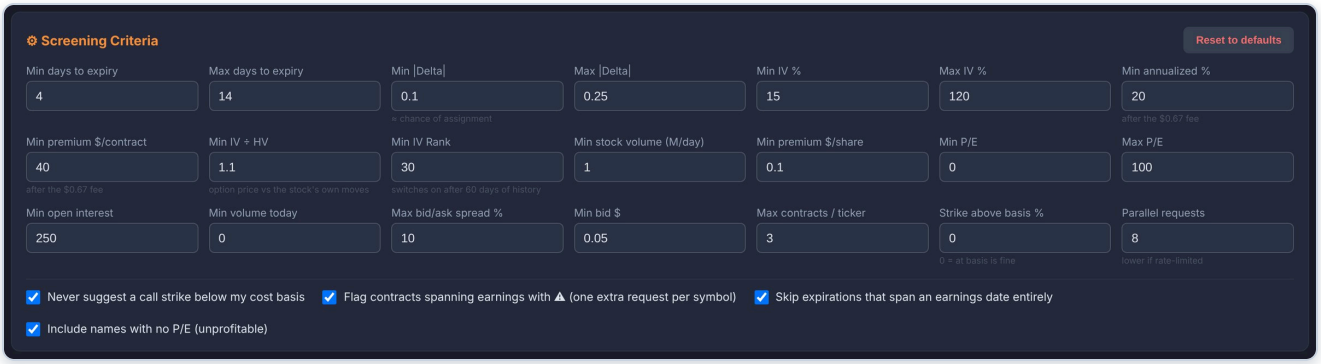
Screening criteria



All the Screener rules

Click ⚙️ **Criteria** to see and change every rule. **Weekly** and **Monthly** fill them in for you; change any box to make your own. **Reset to defaults** puts them back.

Rule	What it means
Min / Max days to expiry	How soon the option must expire.
Min / Max |Delta|	How likely it is to end in the money. Lower is safer.
Min / Max IV %	How richly priced the option must be.
Min annualized %	The lowest yearly return to show, after the fee.
Min premium $/contract, Min premium $/share	Skip options that pay too little.
Min IV ÷ HV	Option price compared with how the stock actually moves. Above 1 means the option is rich.
Min IV Rank	Only used once 60 days of history exist.
Min stock volume (M/day)	Skip thinly traded stocks.
Min / Max P/E	Company valuation limits.
Min open interest, Min volume today, Max bid/ask spread %, Min bid $	Skip contracts that are hard to trade at a fair price.
Max contracts / ticker	How many results per stock at most.
Strike above basis %	For covered calls: how far above your cost the strike must be.
Parallel requests	How many tickers to check at once. Leave it as it is.
Never suggest a call strike below my cost basis	Protects you from selling shares at a loss.
Flag contracts spanning earnings with ⚠	Marks options that expire after an earnings report.
Skip expirations that span an earnings date entirely	Hides them instead.
Include names with no P/E (unprofitable)	Untick to skip companies that lose money.

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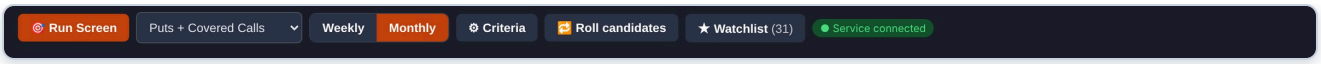
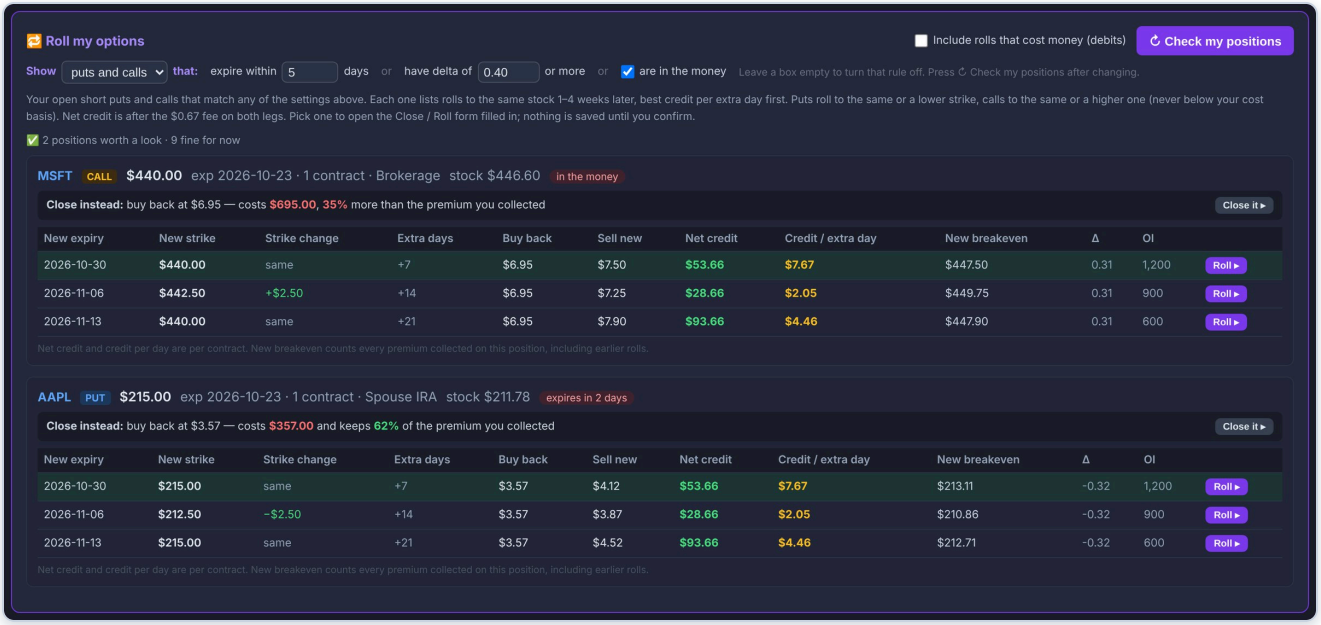


Monthly lit up: the Monthly rules are in use

Which tickers the Screener checks

The Screener checks every ticked name on your watchlist. To add, remove or untick names, click **★ Scanning N tickers · ✎ edit**, or open **🔬 Stock Research → ⭐ Edit my Watchlist** (Chapter 13).

🔁 Roll my options



Roll my options: ideas for options close to expiry

Open **🔍 Find Trades → 🔁 Roll my options** to get ideas for options you already hold. It is a page of its own, and the first time you open it, it checks your positions straight away.

1. In the line at the top, choose **Show** puts and calls, puts only or calls only, and which positions to check: those that **expire within** a number of days, **have delta of** a number **or more**, or **are in the money**. A position shows if it matches any rule that is on. Leave a box empty, or untick in the money, to turn that rule off.
2. Tick **Include rolls that cost money (debits)** if you also want to see rolls that cost you money.
3. Click **↻ Check my positions**.

Each position shows a **Close instead** line: what buying it back would cost, and how much of the premium you would keep, with a **Close it ▸** button. Below it is a table of rolls to the same stock 1 to 4 weeks later, the best **credit per extra day** first:

Column	Meaning
New expiry, New strike, Strike change	The replacement option.

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Column	Meaning
Extra days	How much longer you would hold it.
Buy back, Sell new	Price to close the old one, and premium for the new one.
Net credit	What you collect overall for one contract.
Credit / extra day	Net credit divided by extra days. Higher is better.
New breakeven, Δ, OI	Break-even after the roll, delta and open interest of the new option.

Click **Roll ▸** on a row to open the Close / Roll window already filled in (Chapter 6). Nothing is saved until you click **Confirm Roll**.

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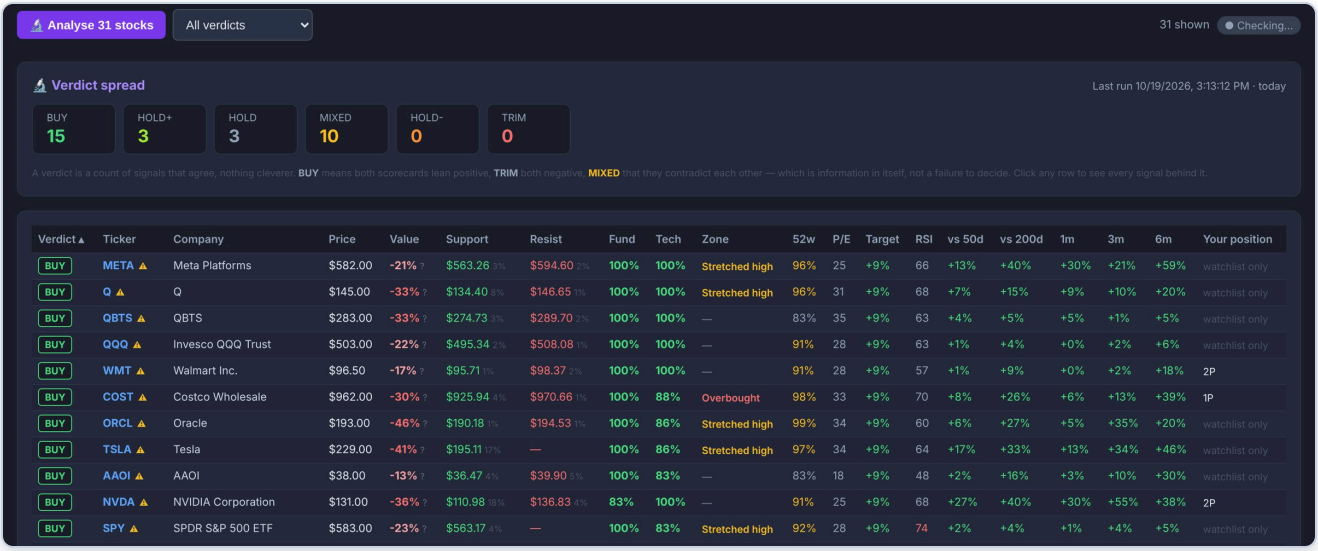
11. Stock Analysis

Open it from 🔬 **Stock Research** → 🔬 **Stock Analysis**. Analysis gives a quick health check of every stock you hold or watch, based on the company's numbers and its price chart.



Stock Analysis after a run

- Click 🔬 **Analyse N stocks** to start. **✕ Cancel** stops a run. Use the drop-down to show only one verdict.
- The **Verdict spread** cards count how many stocks got each verdict.

Verdict	Meaning
BUY	The business numbers and the price trend both look good.
HOLD+	Mostly positive.
HOLD	Neutral.
MIXED	The two views disagree. That is information, not a failure.
HOLD-	Mostly negative.
TRIM	Both views look weak.

Column	Meaning
Price, Value	Today's price, and how it compares with the fair-value estimate.
Support, Resist	Nearby price levels where the stock has turned before.
Fund, Tech	Percent of positive signals in the company's numbers (fundamentals) and in the price chart (technicals).
Zone	Stretched high, Overbought, Oversold or Stretched low, when the price has moved far.
52w	Where the price sits in its range over the past year.

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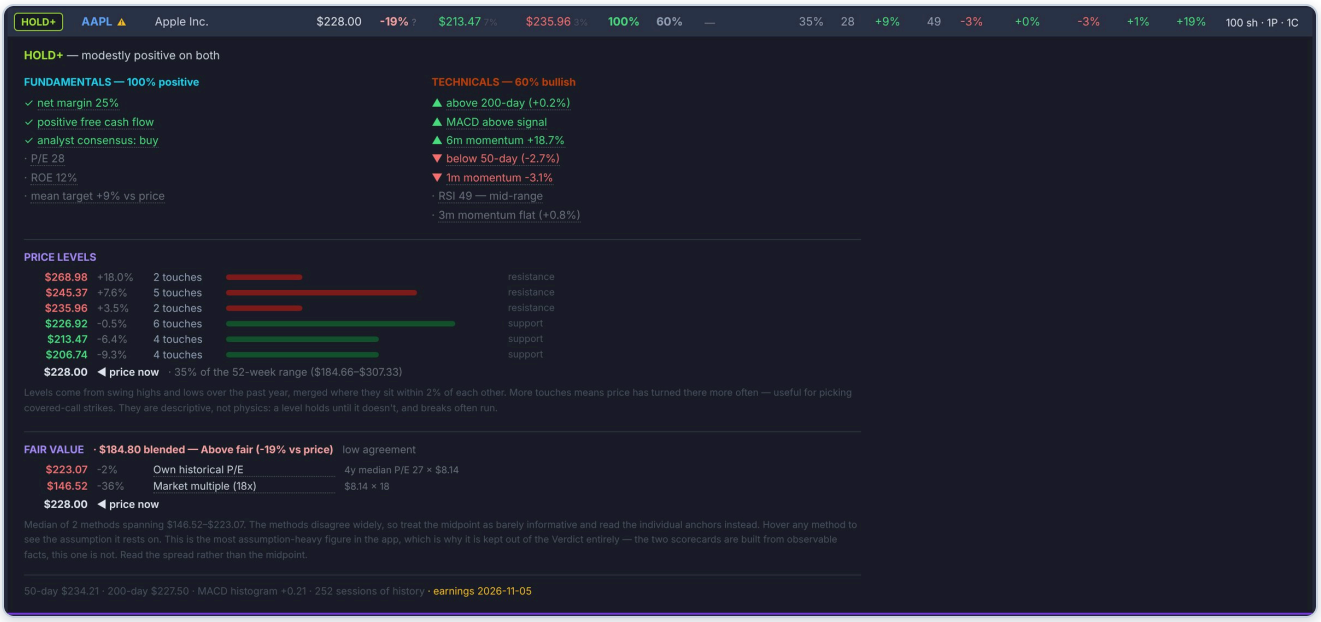
Column	Meaning
P/E, Target	Price to earnings, and the analysts' average target compared with today's price.
RSI	A momentum reading from 0 to 100; above 70 is hot, below 30 is cold.
vs 50d, vs 200d	Price compared with its 50-day and 200-day averages.
1m, 3m, 6m	Price change over 1, 3 and 6 months.
Your position	What you hold: shares (sh), puts (P) and calls (C).

Click any row to open its details: the signals behind the verdict, **Price Levels** with how many times the price touched each one, and **Fair Value** estimates.



Details for one stock

> **Tip:** run Stock Analysis once before using the 🏅 Scorecard's Concentration section; that is where the sectors come from.

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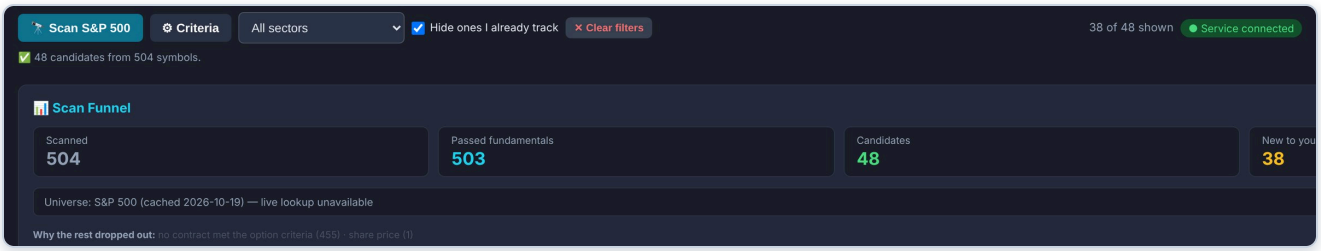
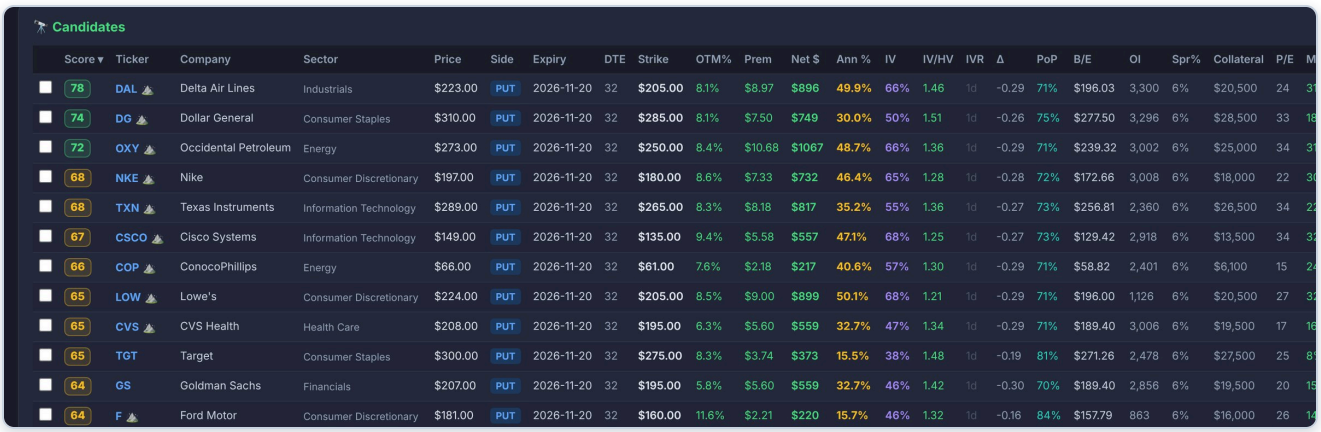
12. Screen S&P 500

Open it from 🔍 **Find Trades** → 🔭 **Screen S&P 500** (it used to be called Discover). It looks through all 500 companies in the S&P 500 to find new names worth adding to your watchlist.



Screen S&P 500 after a scan

1. Click ⚙️ **Criteria** to set the rules (below), or keep the defaults.
2. Click 🔭 **Scan S&P 500**. A full scan takes a few minutes. **✕ Cancel scan** stops it.
3. Read the **Scan Funnel**: how many were scanned, how many passed the business rules, how many had a suitable option, and how many are **New to you**.
4. Use the sector drop-down, **Hide ones I already track** and **✕ Clear filters** to narrow the list.
5. Tick the names you like and click **+ Add N to watchlist**. The Screener (🎯 Screen my Watchlist) will then check them on every run.



Candidates found by the scan

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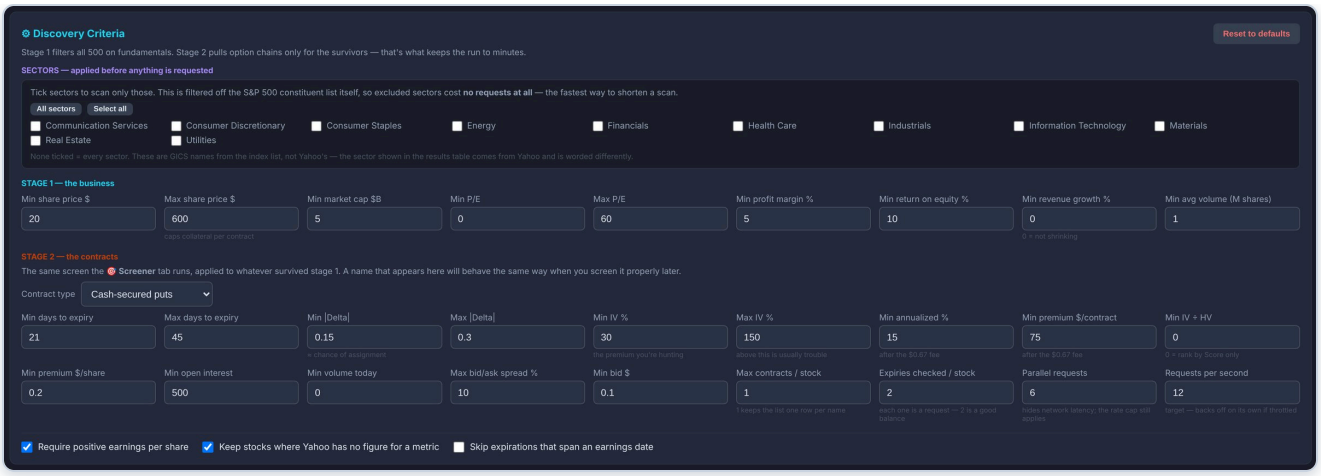

Screen S&P 500 criteria

The criteria have three parts: **Sectors** (tick some to scan only those; none ticked means all), **Stage 1 — the business** (share price, company size, P/E, profit margin, return on equity, revenue growth, trading volume) and **Stage 2 — the contracts** (the same option rules as the Screener). **Reset to defaults** puts them back.

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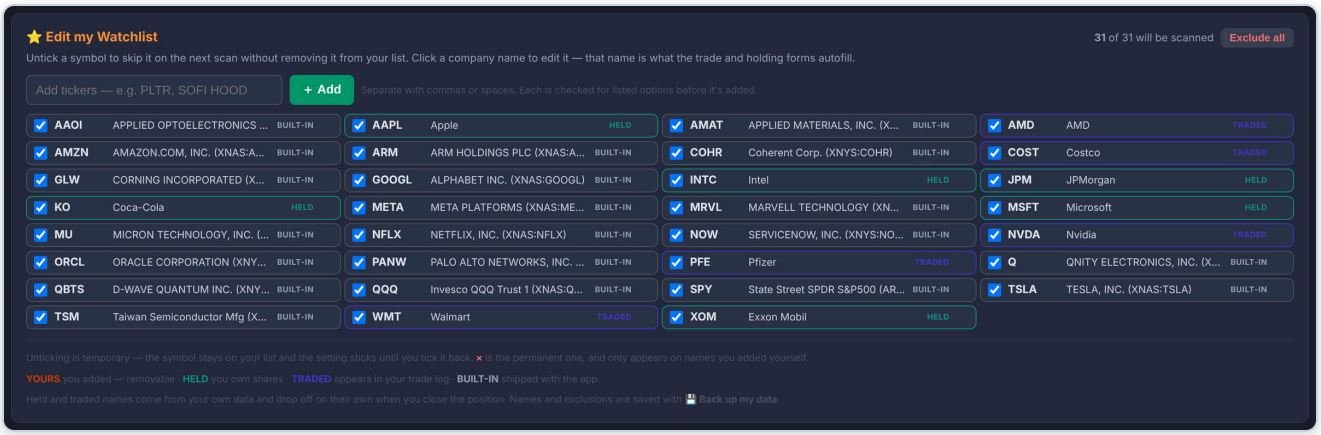
13. Your watchlist: Edit my Watchlist and Watchlist facts

Your watchlist is the list of stocks OptionIQ follows for you. It has two pages, both under 🔬 **Stock Research**.

⭐ Edit my Watchlist



⭐ *Edit my Watchlist*

This is where you keep the list. The Screener (Chapter 10) checks every ticked name on it.

- Type tickers in the box (for example `PLTR, SOFI`) and click **+ Add**. Each one is checked for listed options before it is added.
- **Untick** a name to skip it on the next Screener run without removing it. **Include all** / **Exclude all** tick or untick them all. The top right shows how many will be scanned.
- **×** removes a name you added yourself.
- The tags show where a name came from: **YOURS** (you added it), **HELD** (you own shares), **TRADED** (in your trade log), **BUILT-IN** (comes with the app). Held and traded names drop off by themselves when you no longer have them.
- Click a company name to edit it. That name is what the trade and holding forms fill in.

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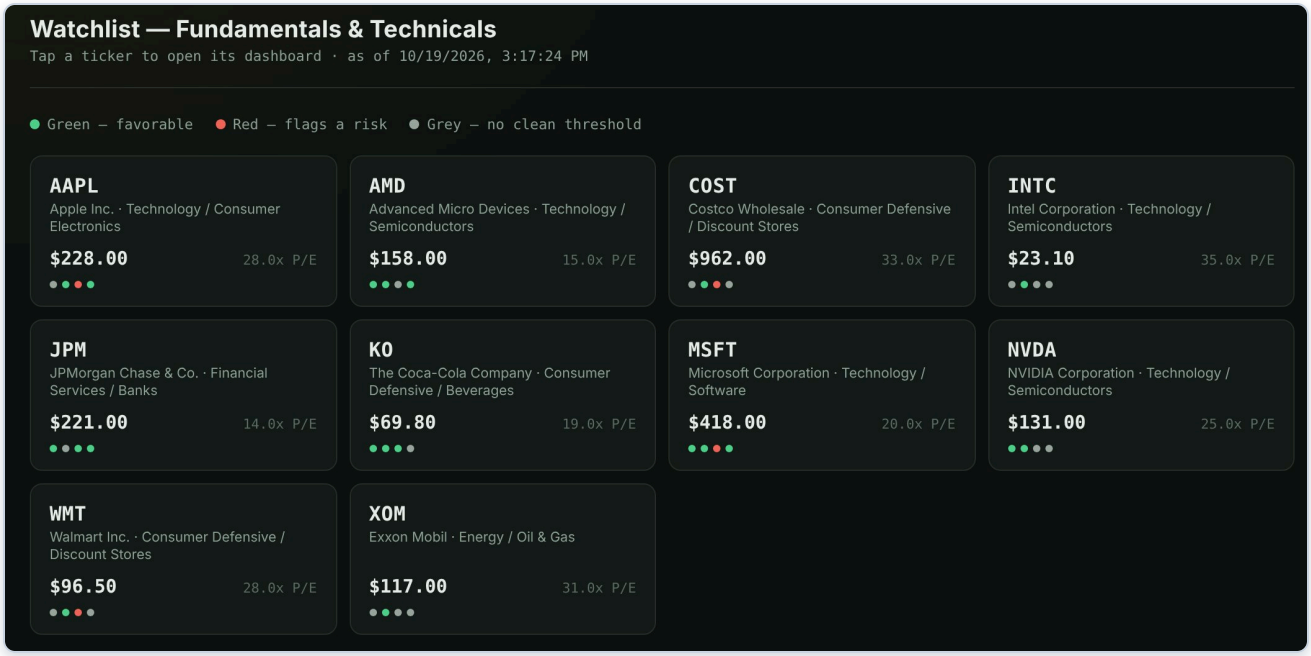
👁 Watchlist facts



A card for each stock on your watchlist

Watchlist facts shows a card for every stock on your watchlist (the same list as ⭐ Edit my Watchlist), with its price and P/E. The figures are looked up when you open the page, so a long list takes a little longer. The coloured dots summarise the company's health: **green** is favourable, **red** flags a risk, **grey** has no clear answer.

Click a card to open its dashboard. Hover over a box for the reasoning behind its colour. **← All tickers** goes back.

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The dashboard for one stock

Box	Meaning
P/E ratio	Price compared with yearly profit per share.
EPS (TTM)	Profit per share over the last 12 months.
Net profit margin	Cents of profit from each dollar of sales.
Debt / Equity	How much the company borrows compared with what it owns.
Revenue, Market cap	Yearly sales and the company's total value.
Beta	How much the stock moves compared with the market. Below 1 is calmer.

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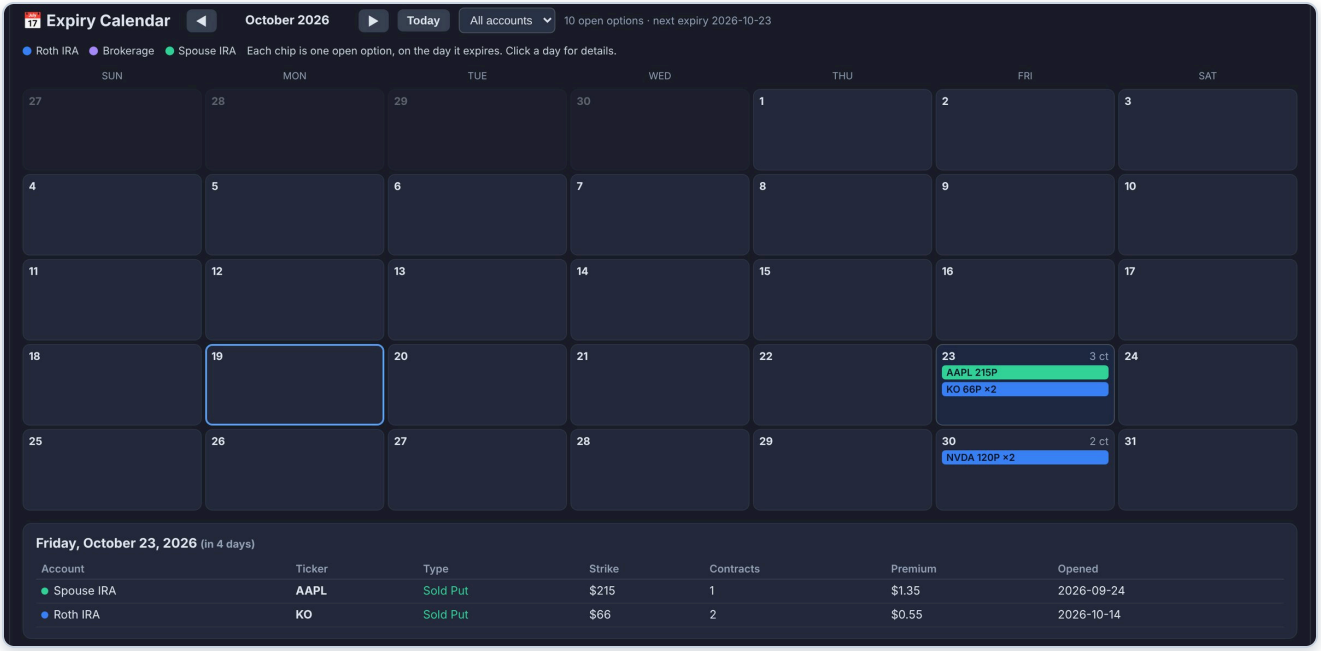
14. The Calendar tab



The expiry calendar, with one day clicked

The Calendar shows each open option on the day it expires, coloured by account.

- ◀ and ▶ change the month; **Today** comes back to this month.
- The drop-down shows **All accounts** or one account.
- Each chip is one open option, for example "KO 66P ×2" (KO, $66 put, 2 contracts). The corner of a day shows the total contracts ("3 ct").
- **Click a day** to list its trades underneath: account, ticker, type, strike, contracts, premium and the day it was opened.

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Part 3. Tools, settings and your information

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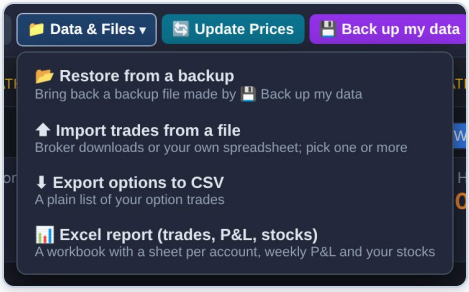
15. Back up, restore and import

All of this is in the 📁 **Data & Files** menu, except 💾 **Back up my data**, which has its own button so it is always one click away.



The 📁 Data & Files menu

Which button do I use?

I want to...	Use	What it does
Make a safety copy of everything	💾 **Back up my data**	Saves trades, stocks and watchlist in one backup file.
Get my information back after a problem, or move to a new computer	📁 Data & Files → 📂 **Restore from a backup**	Brings back a backup file. You choose Merge or Replace.
Bring in trades from my own spreadsheet	📁 Data & Files → ⬆ **Import trades from a file**	Opens the column-matching window. Option trades only.
Bring in my Fidelity downloads	📁 Data & Files → ⬆ **Import trades from a file**	Recognises Fidelity's files and checks them before adding anything.
Give my trades to my accountant, or edit many at once	📁 Data & Files → ⬇️ **Export options to CSV**	A plain list of option trades that opens in any spreadsheet.
A nice report to keep or print	📁 Data & Files → 📊 **Excel report**	A formatted workbook with a sheet per account, weekly P&L and your stocks.

💾 Back up my data

Makes a backup of everything: option trades, stocks and watchlist. A message shows where it was saved: **My Data → Backups**, in a file named with today's date. The newest 30 are kept. The 🔔 reminder tells you when your last backup is more than a week old.

> **Tip:** to be extra safe, copy the newest backup to a USB stick, email it to yourself, or keep your app folder in OneDrive or Google Drive.

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📂 Restore from a backup

Brings back a backup made by 💾 Back up my data (or by the browser version, Options Trade Logger). Use it when something has gone badly wrong and you want to go back, or to move your information to a new computer or a new OptionIQ folder.

1. Click 📁 **Data & Files** → 📂 **Restore from a backup** and pick the backup file (it ends in **.json**).
2. OptionIQ says how many trades and holdings are in the file, and how many you already have. Then it asks how to bring them in: - **OK = Merge**: adds only the trades and holdings you don't already have, and keeps everything else. - **Cancel = Replace**: removes your current information and puts the backup in its place.
3. A message says what was brought in. Any account name in the file that you don't have yet is added for you.

> **Careful:** in this pop-up, **Cancel does not mean stop. It means replace everything.** To keep what you have, press **OK**. Press 💾 Back up my data first, so you can go back if you change your mind.

OptionIQ recalculates every trade's profit each time it starts and each time you restore a backup, so totals are always worked out the same way.

⬆ Import trades from a file

One button for every kind of file. Pick **one file** and OptionIQ opens the right window for it: the Fidelity check (below) for a Fidelity download, or the column-matching window for your own spreadsheet. Pick **several files at once** to bring in a set of Fidelity downloads together.

Your own spreadsheet

Brings in past option trades from a spreadsheet: an Excel file (.xlsx or .xlsm) or a file saved as CSV (.csv, .txt or .tsv). Open and closed trades both come in. Your spreadsheet can have its own layout, for example a download from your broker: you tell OptionIQ which column is which.

1. Click 📁 **Data & Files** → ⬆ **Import trades from a file** and pick your file.
2. The **Import trades** window opens. OptionIQ has already guessed which of your columns is which. Check each box and fix any wrong guess (below).
3. Look at the **Preview** at the bottom: the first 8 trades exactly as they will be saved, and any rows that will be left out.
4. Click ➕ **Add N to my trades**. Nothing is saved before you do.
5. Check the trades on 📋 Options. Importing the same file twice gives you every trade twice.

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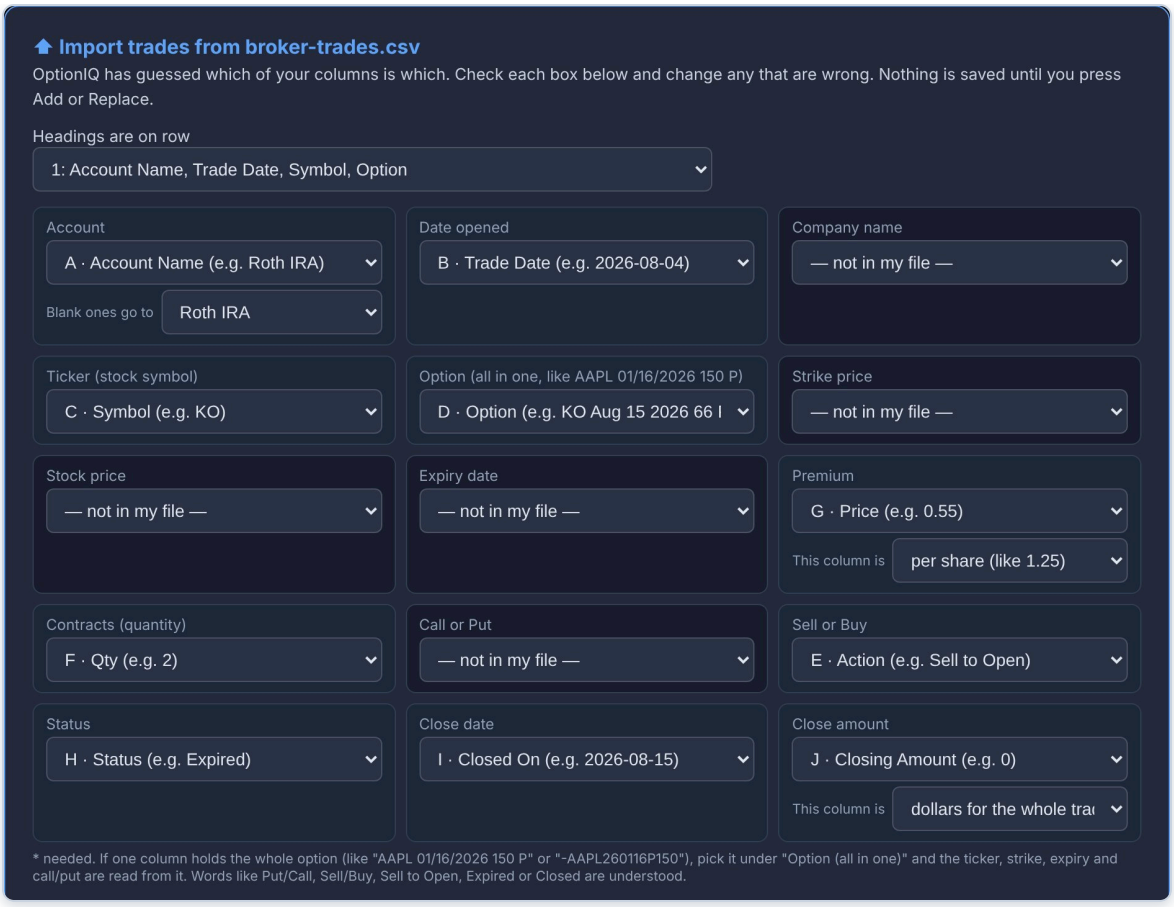

The Import window: one box for each piece of a trade

Part	What it does
Sheet	Only for an Excel file with more than one sheet: pick the sheet that holds your trades. OptionIQ picks the most likely one for you.
Headings are on row	The row that holds your column headings. Change it if your file has a title or notes above the headings.
A box for each field	Account, Date opened, Company name, Ticker, Option (all in one), Strike price, Stock price, Expiry date, Premium, Contracts, Call or Put, Sell or Buy, Status, Close date and Close amount. Each drop-down lists your columns by letter, with an example from your file. Pick **— not in my file —** if you don't have that column.
Blank ones go to	The account used for rows that have no account name.
Option (all in one)	Use this if one column holds the whole option, like "AAPL 01/16/2026 150 P". OptionIQ then reads the ticker, strike, expiry and call or put from it.
This column is (Premium)	Say whether your premium column is **per share** (like 1.25) or **dollars for the whole trade** (like 125).
This column is (Close amount)	The same choice for the close amount.

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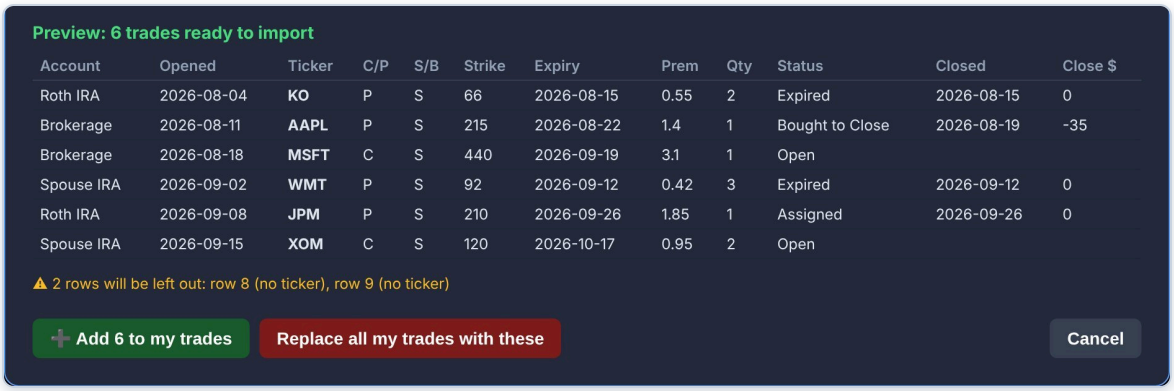
In the example above, OptionIQ guessed the **Status** box wrong (it picked the Action column), so it was changed to **H · Status**. Words your broker uses, like Put or Call, Sell or Buy, Sell to Open, Expired or Closed, are understood. Totals rows are skipped.



The Preview, the rows left out, and the Add and Replace buttons

- **Preview** shows the first 8 trades as they will be saved. If something looks wrong, change a box above and the preview updates at once.
- A yellow ⚠ line lists any rows that will be left out, with the reason, for example "row 8 (no ticker)".
- ➕ **Add N to my trades** adds the trades to the ones you already have.
- **Replace all my trades with these** removes all your option trades and keeps only the ones from this file. The app asks you to confirm first.
- **Cancel** closes the window. Nothing is saved.

If your file has account names that aren't in OptionIQ yet, the app lists them. Press **OK** to create them, or **Cancel** to go back and pick a different Account column.

OptionIQ remembers your choices. The next time you import a file laid out the same way, the boxes are already filled in, and the window says "These are the column choices you used last time".

> **Tip:** an old Excel file (.xls) can't be read. Open it in Excel, choose **File → Save As → Excel Workbook (.xlsx)**, and import the new file. On a Mac in Numbers, use **File → Export To → Excel** or **CSV**.

OptionIQ Sample Import.xlsx still works as a ready-made layout: it holds 8 made-up trades, and you can type your own trades over them. A file made by ⬇️ Export options to CSV imports back too.

Restore or Import: which one?

	📂 Restore from a backup	⬆ Import trades from a file
File it takes	The .json backup made by 💾 Back up my data	A spreadsheet (.xlsx, .xlsm, .csv, .txt, .tsv), or your broker's downloads

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	📂 Restore from a backup	⬆ Import trades from a file
What comes in	Option trades, stocks and watchlist	Option trades (and, from broker files, stock buys, sells and dividends)
To add	Press **OK**: adds only what you don't already have	Click ➕ **Add N to my trades**
To replace	Press **Cancel**: **replaces all your data** with the backup	Click **Replace all my trades with these**, then confirm
Use it for	Going back after a problem, or moving to a new computer	Bringing in trades from a spreadsheet or your broker

Your broker's files (Fidelity)

Brings in the files you download from your broker, so you don't have to type your trades in by hand. Fidelity works today; other brokers will follow. You can use it once to fill OptionIQ when you start, and then as often as you like (for example once a day or once a week) to keep it up to date.

It uses two Fidelity files:

File	Where on Fidelity's website	What OptionIQ does with it
Positions	Positions page → Download	Checks your share counts and cost per share, and your open options, against Fidelity.
Activity & Orders	Activity & Orders page → Download	Adds new option trades, closes, expiries and assignments, stock buys and sells, and reinvested dividends.

1. Sign in to Fidelity in your web browser as usual and press **Download** on the **Positions** page and on the **Activity & Orders** page. On Activity & Orders, choose dates that go back to your last import (Fidelity allows up to a year per file, back 5 years; its standard download covers the last 30 days).
2. In OptionIQ, click 📁 **Data & Files** → ⬆ **Import trades from a file** and pick your Positions file and your Activity file together. For more history, pick several Activity files at once.
3. OptionIQ puts them in order: the Positions file first (only the newest one counts), then the Activity files, oldest first. Any file that isn't a broker file it knows is left out, with a message; import your own spreadsheets one at a time.

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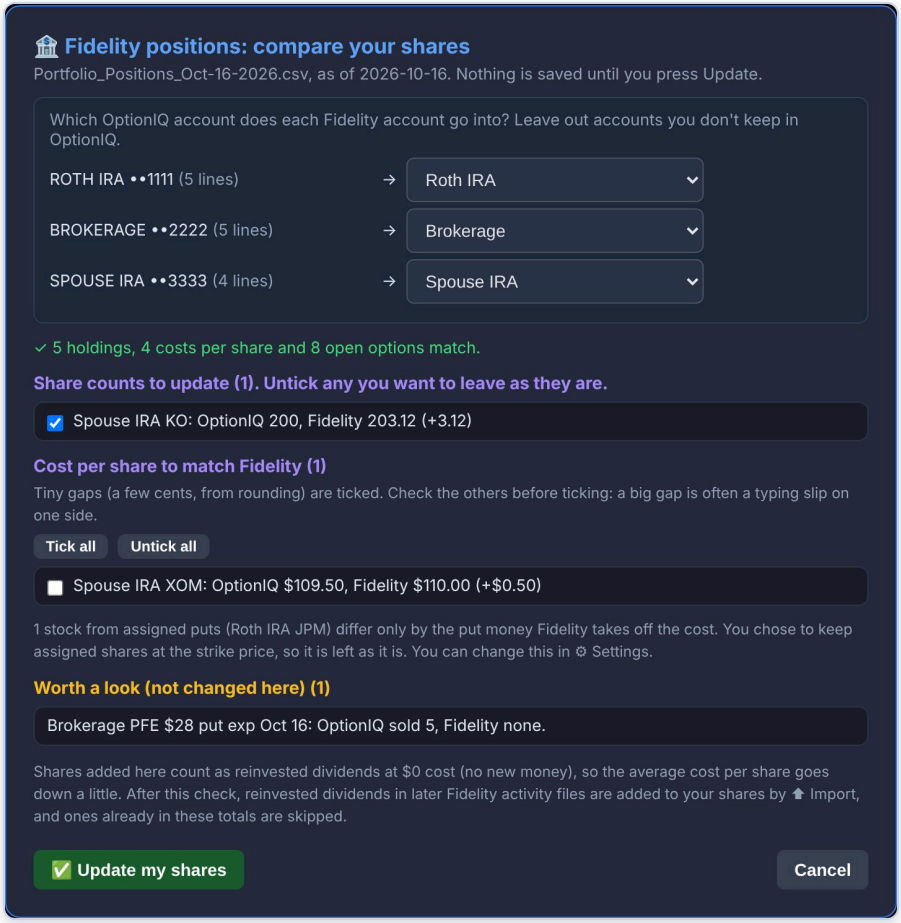
Step 1: compare your shares (Positions file)



The Positions check: tick the fixes you want, then Update my shares

- **Which OptionIQ account does each Fidelity account go into?** OptionIQ matches accounts by name. Pick the right account from each list, choose ➕ **New account** to add a Fidelity account that isn't in OptionIQ yet, or choose **— leave this account out —** for an account you don't keep in OptionIQ. Your choices are remembered.
- A green line says what already matches.
- **Share counts to update** lists holdings where Fidelity has a different number of shares, usually from reinvested dividends. They are ticked; untick any you want to leave as they are. Added shares count as reinvested dividends, at the cost you chose in ⚙️ Settings → Cost per share.
- **Cost per share to match Fidelity** lists holdings whose average cost differs. Tiny rounding gaps are ticked. Check the others before ticking: a big gap is often a typing slip on one side. **Tick all** and **Untick all** help with a long list.
- A grey line explains shares from assigned puts that differ only by the put money, if you chose **Cost = strike price** (Chapter 3).
- **Open options to add** lists open options Fidelity shows that are missing from OptionIQ, for example ones you opened before you started using it. They are ticked; untick any you don't want added.

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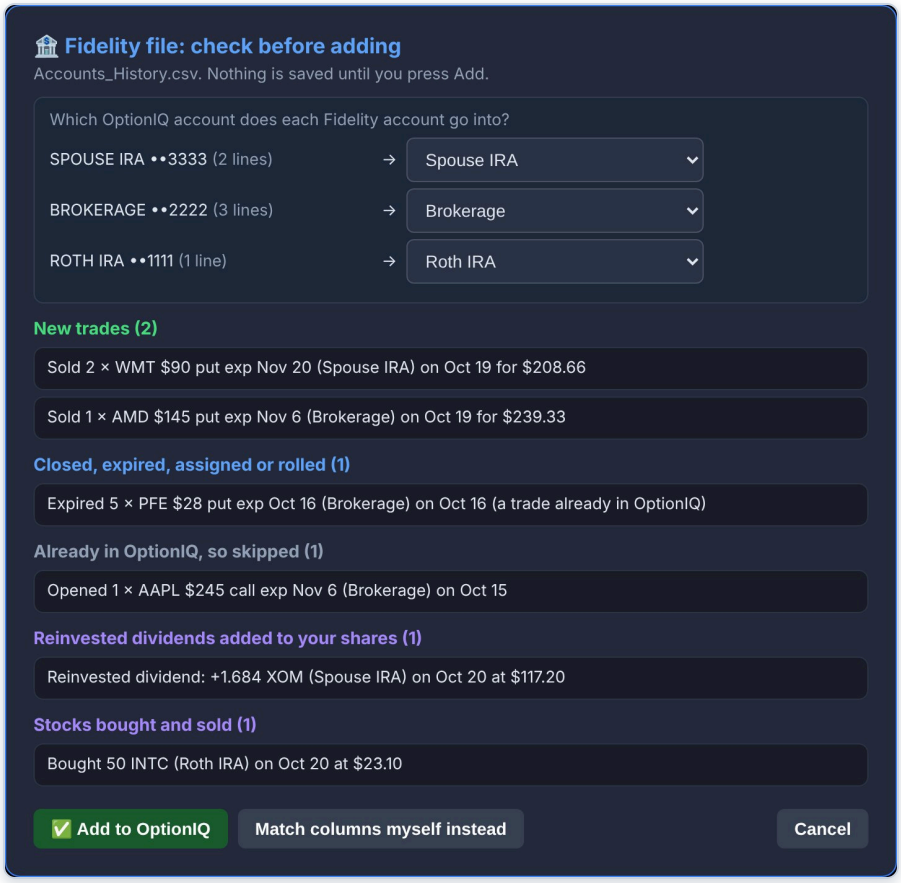
- **Worth a look (not changed here)** lists options that don't match, for example one that expired after you downloaded the file. Fix those yourself on 📋 Options if needed.
- Click ✅ **Update my shares**. Nothing is saved before you do.

Step 2: check before adding (Activity file)



The Activity check: everything OptionIQ will add, in groups

OptionIQ lists what it found, in groups:

Group	What it means
New trades	Options you sold or bought that aren't in OptionIQ yet. They are added.
Closed, expired, assigned or rolled	Closes for trades you already have. They are recorded on those trades.
Already in OptionIQ, so skipped	Lines OptionIQ already has, so nothing is counted twice. Bringing in the same file again is safe.
Needs a look (not added)	Lines OptionIQ couldn't match, for example a close for a trade you never entered. Nothing is changed; fix these yourself if needed.
Recorded differently in OptionIQ (not changed)	For example a called-away call you saved as Assigned. OptionIQ leaves your record as it is.

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Group	What it means
Reinvested dividends added to your shares	Extra shares bought with dividends, at the cost you chose in Settings.
Stocks bought and sold	Share buys are added to 🏦 Stocks as lots of their own; sales are taken from the lots in the order set for that account in ⚙️ Settings → Selling shares, and shown as sold. Lines like "KO: 3 lots with their own dates from your history" mean a holding was split into its lots (see below).
Shares moved between accounts	Shares moved in or out after your Positions check (a rollover or Roth conversion). OptionIQ doesn't change these; add or take away the shares on 🏦 Stocks.
Stock sales that need a look (not added)	A sale of more shares than OptionIQ has. Check the share count on 🏦 Stocks.

Click ✅ **Add to OptionIQ**. A message says how many trades, closes and shares were added. **Match columns myself instead** opens the column-matching window for the same file.

Click 📈 **Stocks only** instead to bring in just your shares: purchases, sales, reinvested dividends and lots. Your option trades stay exactly as they are.

An option trade you typed in yourself is matched with Fidelity's line by ticker, strike, expiry, put or call, and account, even when you entered it on a different day, or as one trade that Fidelity filled in two parts (for example 1 + 4 contracts). So it isn't added twice. A trade typed with a different expiry or account than at Fidelity can't be matched, and shows under **New trades**.

Your shares become lots

The Positions file only gives one total for each stock. The Activity files fill in the history: each purchase, assigned put and reinvested dividend that you still own becomes a lot with its own date and cost, and sales and called-away shares are taken out. Shares from before the dates in your files stay together as **earlier shares**. Shares moved in from another account (a rollover or Roth conversion) stay there too, because Fidelity keeps their first purchase date. You can pick several Activity files at once, in any order, and OptionIQ remembers what it learned from each one. Your share counts always stay as in the Positions file.

If the lots in your history cost more than the total OptionIQ had for a stock, the earlier shares are set to $0 a share and a message tells you; check that stock's cost on 🏦 Stocks. This often happens with assigned puts when you chose **Cost = strike price** and Fidelity counts them at the strike less the put money.

The first time, and after that

The first time: if you already typed in your option trades, bring in your history with 📈 **Stocks only**. Fidelity's Activity download covers the last 30 days; for your full history, choose a date range on Fidelity's Activity page (up to a year per file) and download a file for each year back to your oldest

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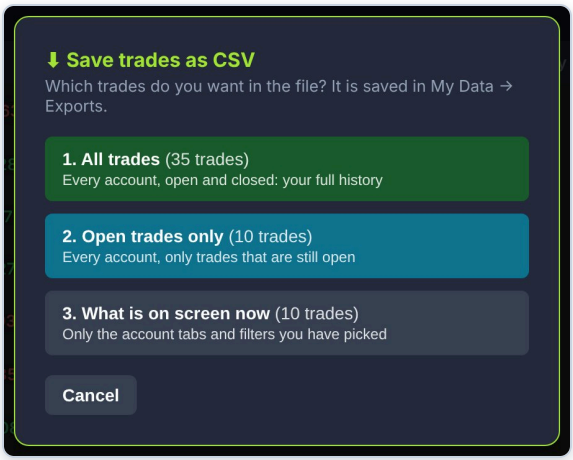
holding. Pick the Positions file and all the Activity files together. Press ✅ **Update my shares** in the Positions check, then 📈 **Stocks only** for each Activity file.

Every week (or day) after that: download a new Activity file and import it with ✅ **Add to OptionIQ**. Lines OptionIQ already has are skipped, so nothing is counted twice: new trades are added, closes and assignments are recorded on your trades, and new purchases, sales and dividends update your lots. For your first full import after a Stocks-only catch-up, look over the **New trades** list before you press Add: the 30-day file includes some older option lines, and one you typed with a different expiry or account would appear there. Fix your trade first, or use Stocks only that one time.

> **Tip:** do Step 1 (Positions) at least once before relying on stock buys, sells and reinvested dividends. Until then, OptionIQ lists them but waits, so they can't be counted twice. After the first check, later Activity files only add what happened since.

> **Tip:** press 💾 Back up my data before your first big import, so you can go back if something looks wrong.

⬇️ Export options to CSV



⬇️ Export options to CSV asks which trades to save

Saves your option trades as a plain list, one row per trade, that opens in Excel or any spreadsheet. It asks which trades: **1** all trades, open and closed; **2** open trades only; or **3** what is on screen now (after your filters). Handy for taxes or your accountant, or to change many trades at once: export, edit in Excel, then bring the file back with ⬆ Import trades from a file. It is not a backup: it holds option trades only.

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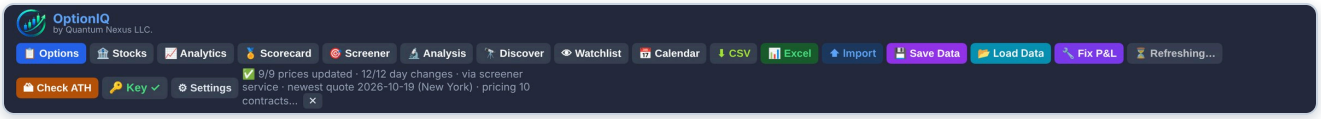
📊 Excel report (trades, P&L, stocks)

Saves a formatted Excel workbook: a sheet of trades for each account, a Summary, Weekly P&L and Weekly Premium sheets, a stock holdings sheet for each account and a Stock Analytics sheet. While it is being made, the menu item reads **Building the Excel report...**.

Both are saved in **My Data → Exports** inside your app folder, and a message says where.

🔄 Update Prices



The price status line, after 🔄 Update Prices

Fetches the latest stock prices (with your Finnhub key) and option prices (through the Screener's helper). While it works, the button reads **Updating...**. A status line under the buttons says how many prices were updated; click its ✕ to hide it.

It also checks SPY and QQQ against their all-time highs. When either one sets a new record, a 🎉 **New all-time high!** message appears next to the buttons for a few seconds, and the ATH figures next to the account tabs move up. The same check runs when OptionIQ starts.

While OptionIQ is open, 🔄 **Update Prices** also runs by itself every 5 minutes during US market hours (9:30 AM to 4 PM New York time, Monday to Friday). The option prices also go to the phone app.

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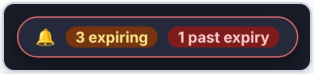
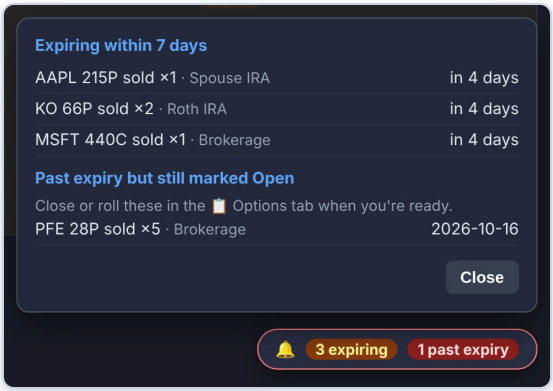
16. Reminders



The 🔔 reminder button in the bottom-right corner

The 🔔 button sits in the bottom-right corner whenever something needs your attention. Click it to see the list.

- **"expiring"**: open options that expire within 7 days (you can change the number of days in ⚙️ Settings).
- **"past expiry"**: options whose expiry date has passed but are still marked Open. The app never changes them on its own; close or roll them yourself.
- **"Backup due"**: your last backup is more than a week old. Click 💾 **Back up now** right there.



The reminder list, opened

While the app is open, Windows (or your Mac) also shows a small pop-up once a day about options expiring soon.

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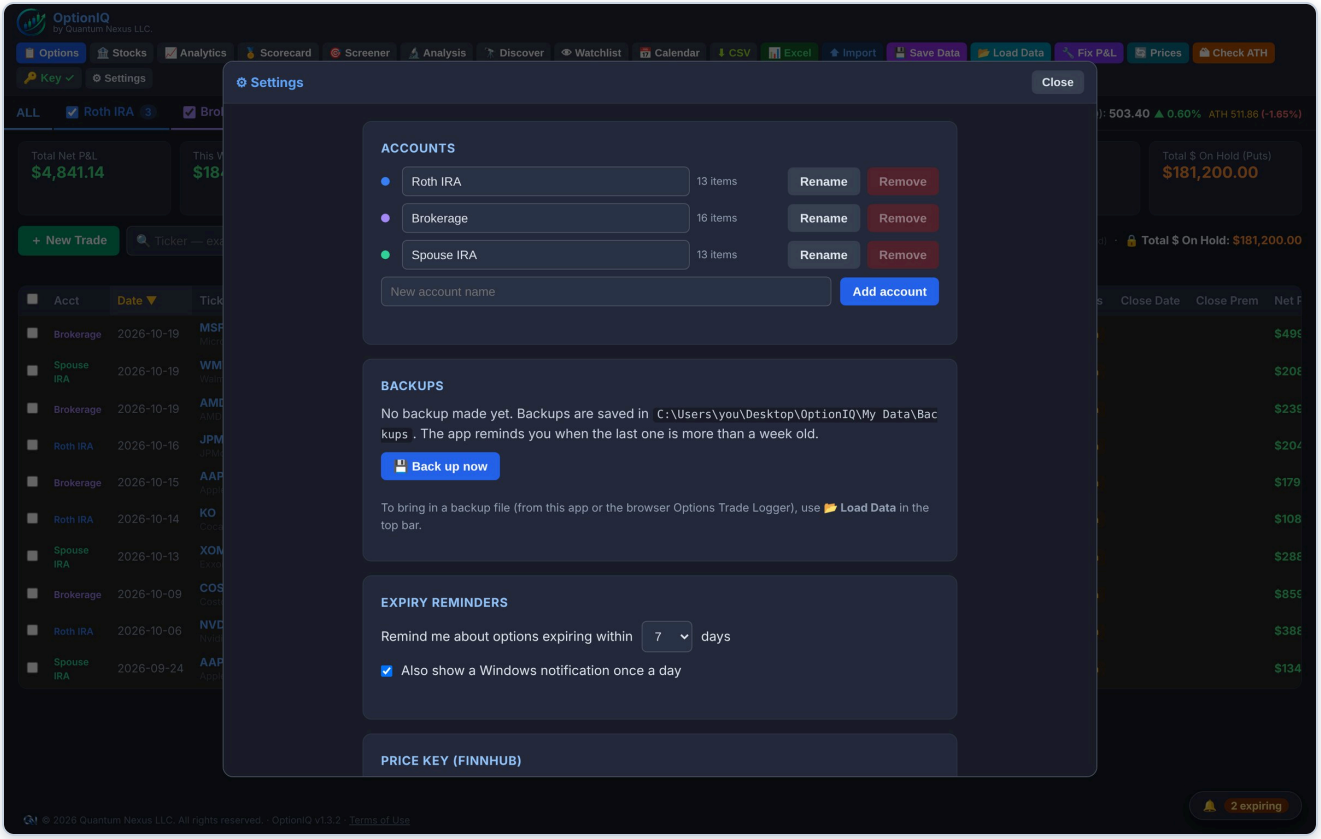
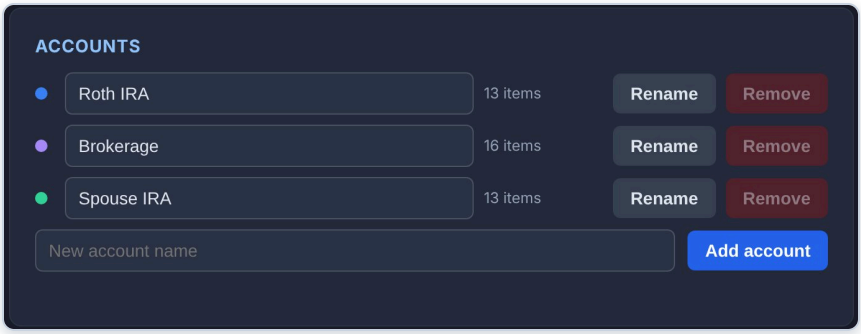
17. Settings



⚙️ Settings opens in a window over the app. Click Close at the top right when done.

⚙️ Settings has eight parts.

Accounts



Accounts

- **Rename** an account: type the new name and click Rename. Its trades follow the new name.
- **Remove** works only for an account with no trades or holdings ("0 items").
- Type a name in **New account name** and click **Add account** to add one.

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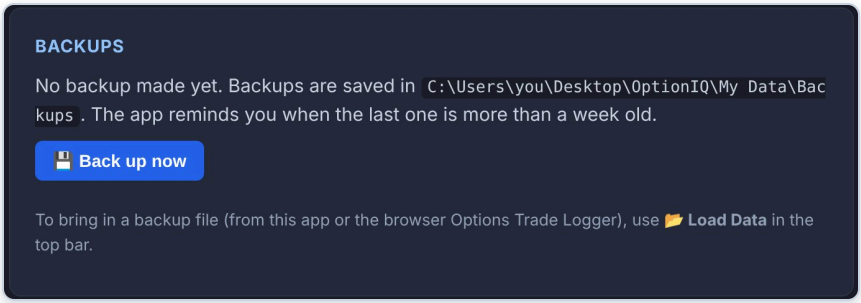
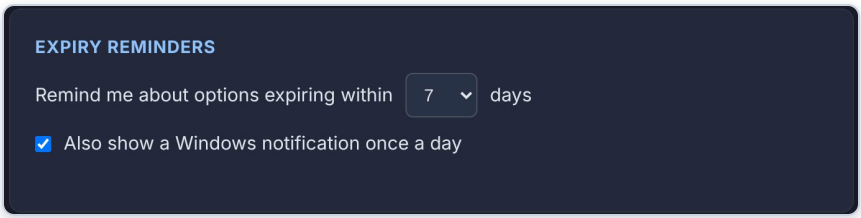
Backups



Backups

Shows when you last backed up and where backups are saved. 💾 **Back up now** makes one. The app reminds you when the last one is more than a week old.

Expiry reminders



Expiry reminders

Choose how many days ahead (1 to 30) to be reminded of expiring options, and whether to also show a Windows (or Mac) notification once a day.

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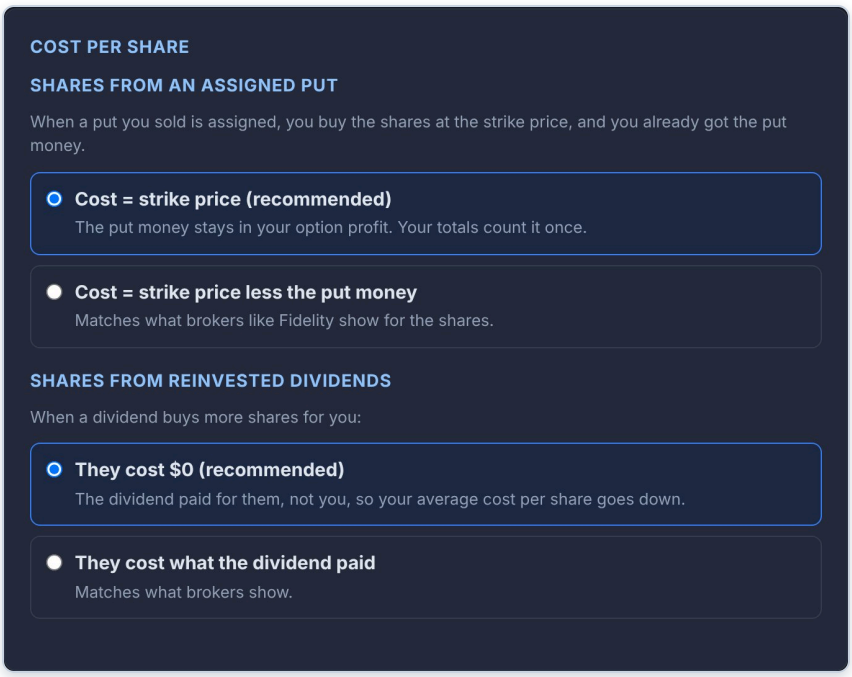
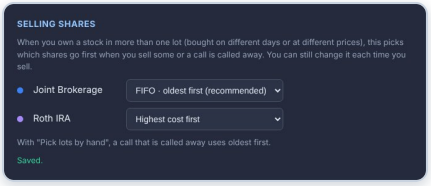
Cost per share



Cost per share

The same two choices as in setup (Chapter 3): what assigned put shares and reinvested dividend shares cost you. Your choice is saved as soon as you click it and is used from then on; shares already in the app keep their cost.

Selling shares



Selling shares: the sale method for each account

When you own a stock in more than one lot, this sets which shares go first when you sell some, or when a call is called away: **FIFO · oldest first** (recommended, and the starting choice), **LIFO · newest first**, **Highest cost first** or **Pick lots by hand**. Each account has its own setting, saved as soon as you change it. You can still choose differently each time you sell (Chapter 7). With Pick lots by hand, a call that is called away uses oldest first.

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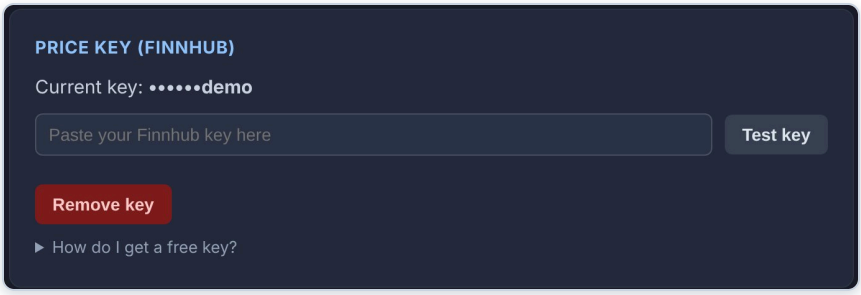
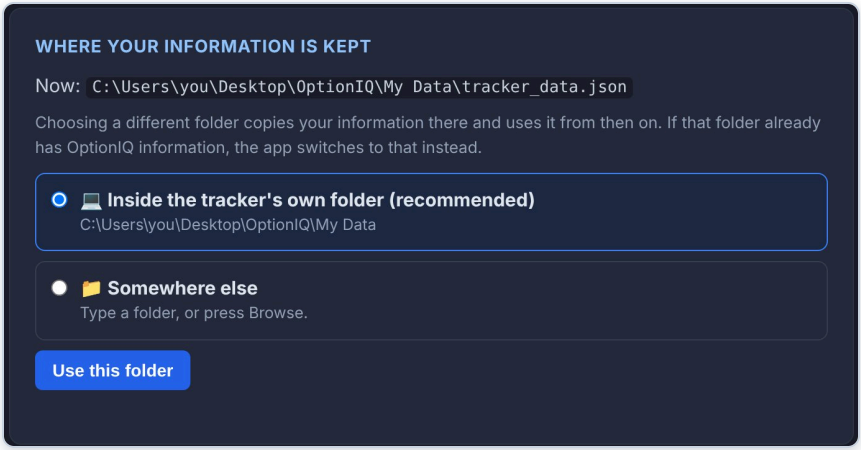
Price key (Finnhub)



Price key

Shows the end of the key you saved. Paste a new key and click **Test key** to change it, or click **Remove key**. **How do I get a free key?** opens the steps from Chapter 4.

Where your information is kept



Where your information is kept

Shows the file your information is in now. Choose **Inside the tracker's own folder (recommended)**, or **Somewhere else** (for example a OneDrive or Google Drive folder; type it or click **Browse**), then click **Use this folder**. The app copies your information there and uses it from then on. If that folder already has OptionIQ information, the app switches to that instead.

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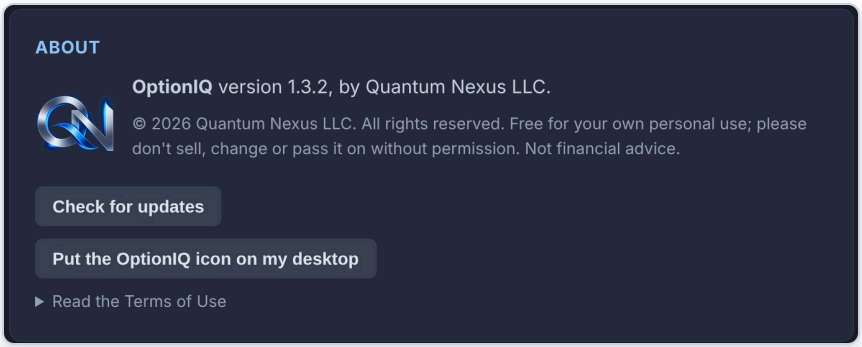
About



About

Shows your version. **Check for updates** looks for a new version right now. **Put the OptionIQ icon on my desktop** puts the icon back if you deleted it. **Read the Terms of Use** shows the terms.

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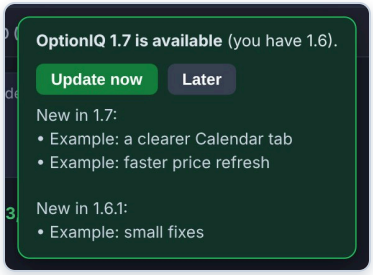
18. Updates



A new version is ready

The app looks for a new version when it starts and every 6 hours. When one is ready, a green note appears at the top right. The **Update now** and **Later** buttons are at the top, and under them a list of what's new in every version since the one you have. If the list is long, it scrolls.

1. Click **Update now**, then **OK**.
2. The app first backs up your information, then downloads the new version. The note shows how far along it is.
3. The app closes and opens again by itself, in the same folder. The footer shows the new version number.

Your trades, stocks, settings and price key stay exactly as they were. **Later** hides the note until the next start.

If the update can't finish (for example the internet drops), the note turns red and nothing is changed. Click **Try again**, or **Download it myself** to get the new zip and extract it over your app folder. On Windows, choose **Replace** when asked about files that already exist. On a Mac, move your **My Data** and **Settings** folders into the new OptionIQ folder.

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19. The OptionIQ phone app

The phone app is a small companion to OptionIQ on your computer. Use it to see your open trades, check what expires soon, log a new trade, close or roll a trade, and add a stock to your watchlist while you are away from your computer. It works on iPhone and Android.

It needs two things: OptionIQ 1.6 or newer on your computer, and your **My Data** folder kept in **OneDrive** (⚙️ Settings → Where your information is kept). Google Drive and Dropbox are planned for later.

How the phone and computer stay in step

Your computer stays in charge of your records.

1. Every time your information changes, OptionIQ on the computer writes a small **phone copy** in **My Data → Phone**. OneDrive carries it to the cloud.
2. The phone reads that copy. It never changes your main records.
3. When you add or change something on the phone, the phone leaves a small note in **My Data → Phone → inbox**. The next time OptionIQ is open on your computer, it reads the note, adds the change with its own sums, and shows you what it added.

OneDrive can take a few minutes to carry files between the phone and the computer. Until the computer has added a change, the phone shows **Waiting for computer** next to it.

Microsoft ends the phone's OneDrive sign-in about once a day. When you open the phone app after that, it first tries to sign in again by itself. If Microsoft needs you, a **Sign in to OneDrive again** box opens and a yellow banner says how many changes are waiting to be sent. Tap **Sign in**. Your changes stay on the phone until then.

Installing it on your phone

1. On your phone, open **https://skjaggi.github.io/optioniq-updates/phone/**. Use **Safari** on an iPhone, or **Chrome** on Android.
2. iPhone: tap the ··· button (three dots) at the bottom right of Safari, tap **Share**, then scroll down and tap **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**. On older iPhones the **Share** button (a square with an arrow) is right in the bottom bar, so you can skip the three dots.
3. Android: tap the ⋮ menu at the top right of Chrome, then **Add to Home screen** or **Install app**.
4. Open OptionIQ from the new icon on your home screen. Read the Terms of Use, tick the box, and tap **Continue**.

The app opens with **sample data** so you can look around. To see your own trades, go to **More**, tap **Change**, choose **OneDrive** and sign in with your Microsoft account. Then tap **Choose folder** and pick your OptionIQ **My Data** folder.

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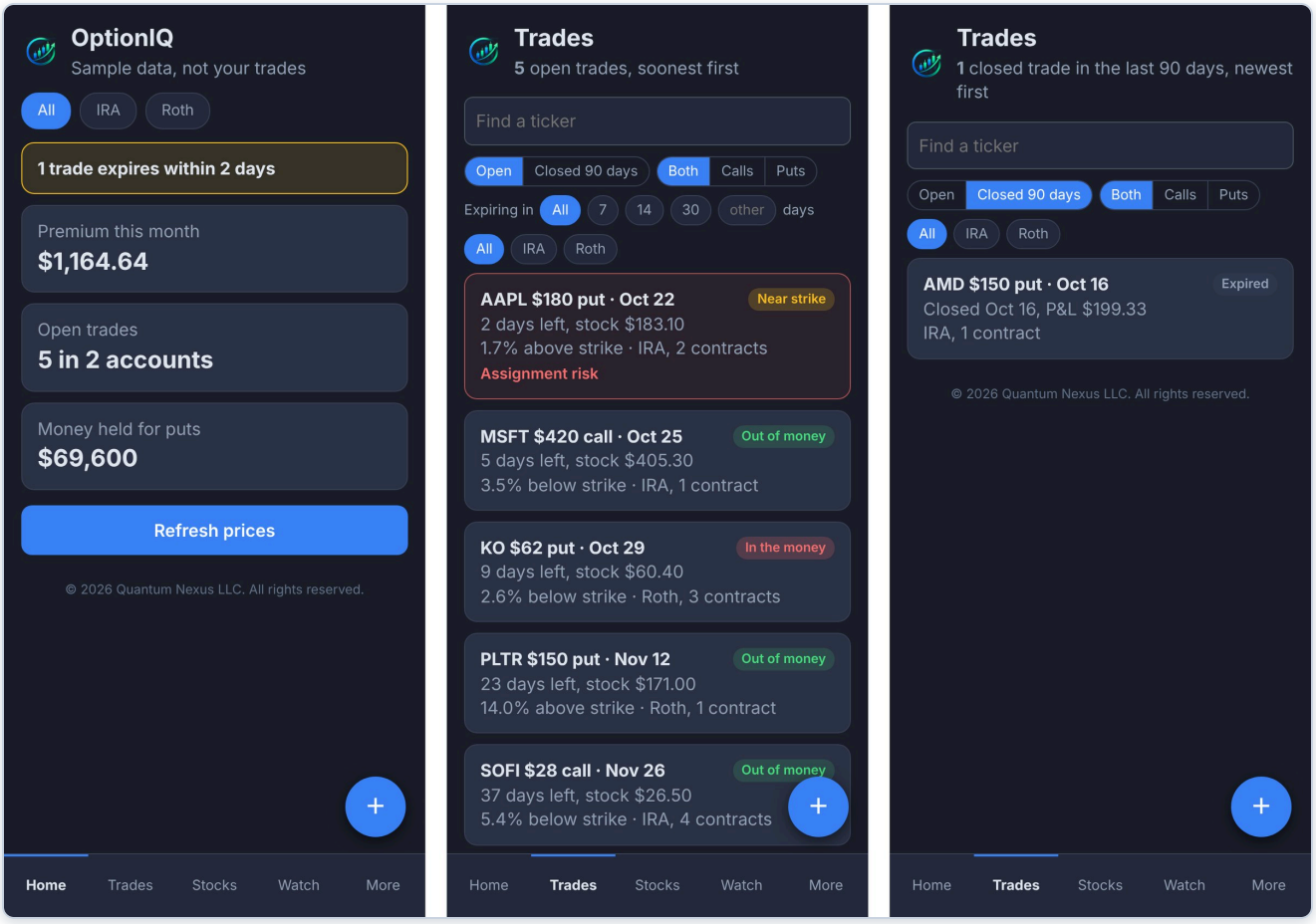
If the phone says "OptionIQ on your computer hasn't made its phone copy yet", update OptionIQ on the computer to 1.6 or newer, open it once, wait a few minutes for OneDrive, and try again. If it says "Couldn't reach OneDrive … 404" right after that, OneDrive has not uploaded the phone copy yet: wait a few minutes and choose the folder again.

The five tabs



Home, Options (Open) and Options (Closed 90 days) on the phone

Tab	What it shows
Home	Trades that expire within 2 days, a green 🎯 **N options at 80%+ profit** box (tap it to see them), and the same eight summary boxes as the top of the computer's Options tab, with its own **Week
Options	Your option trades, like the computer's Options tab. Tap **Open** or **Closed 90 days**, and **Both**, **Calls** or **Puts**. The line under the title counts what is shown, for example *6 open puts expiring within 7 days*. On Open, the **Expiring in** buttons (**All**, **7**, **14**, **30**, or type your own number of days) narrow the list. Each card shows the ticker, strike, type and expiry date, for example *KO $62 put · Oct 29*, plus days left and how near the stock is to the strike. Open options also show what you sold them at (or paid), their price now and the profit captured, for example *Sold at $2.10 · now $0.15 · 93% captured* 🎯. The 🎯 **80%+ profit** button shows only the ones at your target.

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Tab	What it shows
Stocks	The shares you own, with a box for your total value and total gain or loss. Each stock shows its price, **Today** (today's change in dollars and percent, after 🔄 **Refresh prices** at the top of the tab), its value and its gain or loss in dollars and percent. Sort the list with the **Symbol**, **Price**, **Value**, **Shares** and **Gain %** buttons; tap the same button again to reverse the order. Stock buys and sells are entered on the computer.
Watch	Your watchlist with prices. Tap **+** to add a stock; it is added to the watchlist on your computer too.
More	Where your data comes from, the 🎯 profit target (the computer's to start, 80%), the near-strike warning (3% to start), Face ID or passcode to open, and the Terms of Use.

Tapping **Refresh prices** on Home gets live option prices from the OptionIQ price server (a small Quantum Nexus web service that asks Yahoo Finance, the same source the computer uses). It only sends the option contracts, never your accounts or amounts, and works even when your computer is off. Without it, the prices come from your computer's last 🔄 **Update Prices** (it runs every 5 minutes while OptionIQ is open in market hours). The line under the list says which: "Live option prices" or "Option prices from your computer's last 🔄 Update Prices", with the time.

The account buttons (**All** and each account name) pick which accounts are shown. The **+** button logs a new trade on Home and Options, adds a stock on Watch, and is hidden on Stocks and More. When **All** accounts are shown, the new trade form asks you to choose the account; with one account picked above, it starts on that account.

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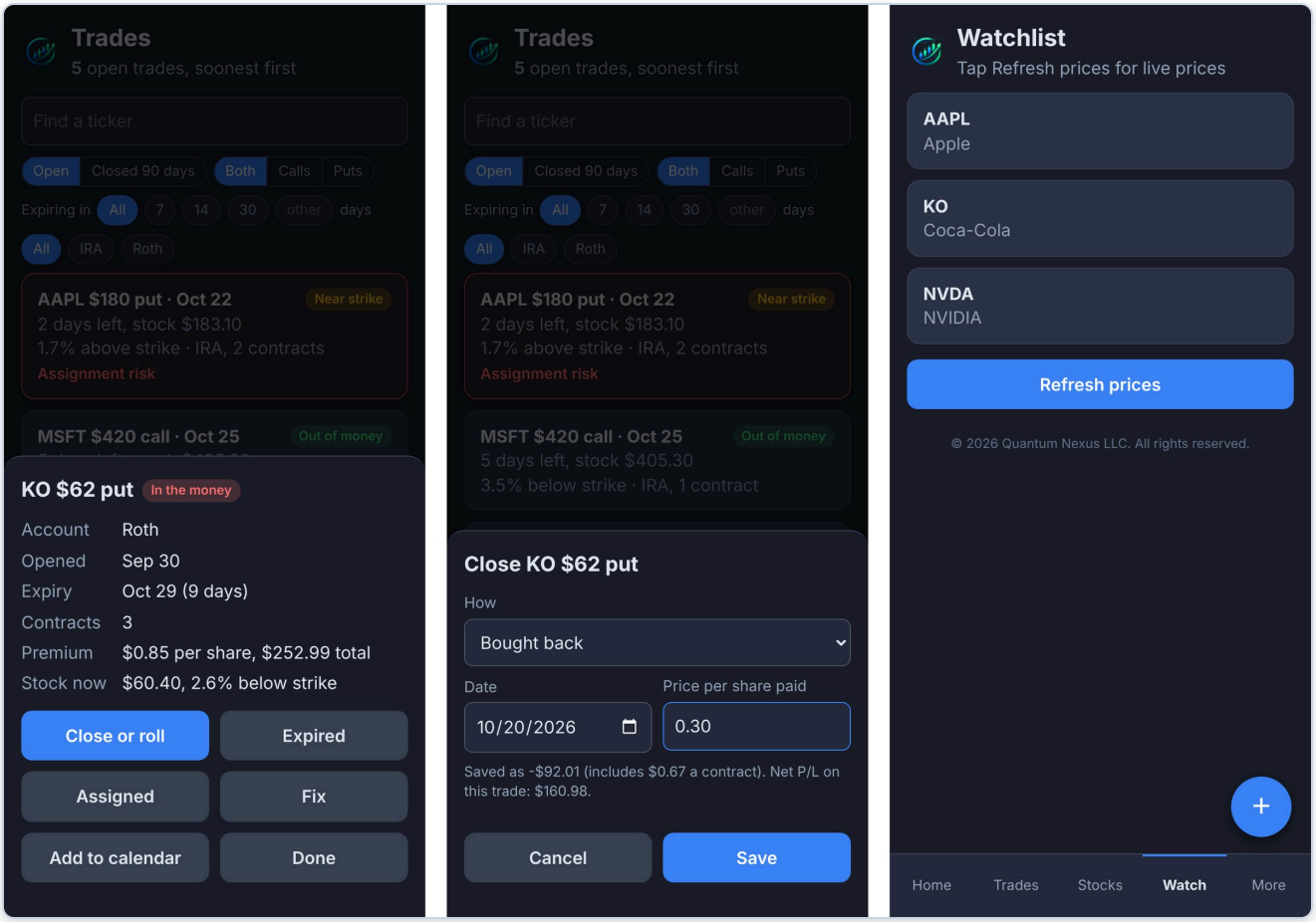
Closing, rolling and fixing a trade



A trade, the Close form with a price per share, and the Watchlist

Tap a trade to see its details.

Button	What it does
Close or roll	Choose how it ended (**Bought back**, or **Rolled**), how many **Contracts to close** (for a trade with 2 or more; the rest stay open as their own trade), the date, and the **price per share** with no minus sign, just like on the computer. The line under it shows what will be saved and the trade's net profit. For a roll, also fill in the new expiry, strike and premium.
Expired / **Assigned**	One tap to close it that way. An assigned put adds the shares on your computer.
✂️ **Split**	Only for trades with 2 or more contracts. Type how many contracts go into a new trade; both parts show right away, so you can roll one and mark the other assigned (see Chapter 6, Splitting a trade).
Fix	Change a detail of an open trade, or of one closed in the last 90 days.
Add to calendar	Puts the expiry in your phone's calendar with an alert 2 days before. **Add expiries to calendar** on the Options tab does all of them.

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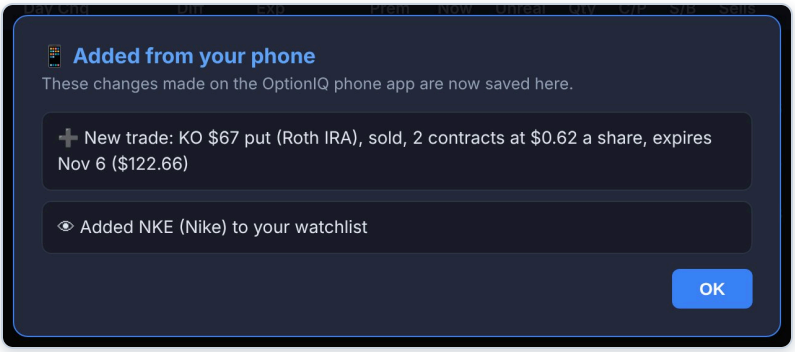
What you see on the computer



The computer shows exactly what came in from the phone

When OptionIQ on your computer adds changes from the phone, a window opens in the middle of the screen listing each one in plain words: new trades, closes, rolls, fixes and watchlist additions. Click **OK**. If a change could not be added (for example, the trade was deleted on the computer first), it is listed in amber with the reason.

> **Tip:** your trades stay in your own OneDrive. Quantum Nexus LLC. never receives them.

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Part 4. Training and help

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20. Practice exercises

These exercises use made-up trades, so you can practise without touching your real records. Make a separate practice copy: unzip OptionIQ into a new folder called **OptionIQ Practice**, set it up with any account names, and delete the folder when you are done.

Exercise 1: Bring in sample trades

1. In your practice copy, click 📁 **Data & Files** → ⬆ **Import trades from a file** and pick **OptionIQ Sample Import.xlsx**. Check the boxes and the Preview, then click ➕ **Add 8 to my trades**. If it lists account names you don't have, press **OK** to create them.
2. On 📋 Options, open ⚙️ **Filters**, set Status to **All**, and see all 8 trades.
3. Click the **Net P&L** heading to sort by profit. Which trade made the most?

Exercise 2: Log a cash-secured put

1. Click **+ New Trade**. Pick an account, type `KO`, strike `66`, an expiry date two Fridays from now, premium `0.55`, contracts `2`, **P – Put**, **S – Sell**.
2. Check the line under the form: Sells about $108.66 and $13,200.00 on hold. Click **Add Trade**.
3. Look at the **Total $ On Hold (Puts)** card: it went up by $13,200.

Exercise 3: Close a trade that expired

1. Find the KO put and click **Close**.
2. Choose **Expired**, leave the price per share empty, and click **Confirm**. The trade moves to Closed with the full premium as profit.

Exercise 4: A put is assigned, then sell a covered call

1. Log another put, then **Close** it as **Assigned**.
2. Go to 🏦 Stocks: the shares are there with status **Assigned**, at the strike price.
3. Turn on ⚙️ **Filters** → **Covered Call Opportunity**: the new shares are listed.
4. Open 🔍 **Find Trades** → 🎯 **Screen my Watchlist**, choose **Covered Calls only** and click 🎯 **Run Screen**. Click **+ Log** on a call above your cost and add it.
5. When the call ends, close it on 📋 Options as **Expired**, or as **Called Away** if your shares were sold.

Exercise 5: Roll an option

1. Open 🔍 **Find Trades** → 🔁 **Roll my options**, set **expire within** to 7 days and click 🗘 **Check my positions**.
2. Pick a row with a good **Credit / extra day** and click **Roll ▸**.

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3. Check the numbers in the window and click **Confirm Roll**.
4. Open 🏅 Scorecard: your roll appears under **Rolled vs. left alone**.

Exercise 6: Your weekly routine

1. Start the app and click 🔄 **Update Prices**.
2. Click the 🔔 button. Close or roll anything past expiry.
3. Check 📅 Calendar for the coming week.
4. Run 🎯 **Screen my Watchlist** (Weekly) and log any trades you place at your broker.
5. If you use Fidelity, download your Activity file and bring it in with ⬆ **Import trades from a file** → ✅ **Add to OptionIQ** (Chapter 15).
6. Click 💾 **Back up my data**.

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21. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Nothing opens when I double-click Start OptionIQ	Check there is an **app** folder next to it and that unzipping had finished. Try again and wait 10 seconds. If it still won't start, send the file **OptionIQ startup error.txt** from the app folder to whoever shared the app with you.
A blue "Windows protected your PC" box	Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
Mac: "Start OptionIQ.command" can't be opened	System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway (Chapter 2).
Update now says "No such file or directory ... Settings/update/..."	Open the **Settings** folder inside your OptionIQ folder, make a new folder there named **update**, then click **Update now** again. Versions from 1.11 on do this by themselves.
The Screener says the service isn't connected	Click ↻ **Retry**. If that doesn't help, close the app and start it again.
Screen my Watchlist, Stock Analysis or Screen S&P 500 are empty on first start	Wait for the blue one-time download message to finish.
Prices don't update	Check your internet, then ⚙️ Settings → Price key → **Test key**.
Trades seem to be missing	Check the account tabs (all ticked?) and the ⚙️ **Filters** count. Click ✕ **Clear**.
A total looks wrong	Close OptionIQ and start it again: every trade's profit is recalculated at start. If it is still wrong, check that trade's premium, contracts and close amount with ✏️.
A broker file is "left out" when I import several files	Only broker files can be picked together. Import your own spreadsheet on its own.
An option shows "⌛ expired — still open"	Close it as Expired, Assigned or Called Away.
Concentration shows "Unclassified"	Run 🔬 Stock Research → Stock Analysis once.
Something else	Send the files **tracker.log** and **screener.log** (on a Mac also start.log) from the **Settings** folder to whoever shared the app with you. They hold no trades and no keys.

Where everything is kept. Your app folder holds **My Data** (your trades, backups and exports) and **Settings** (your choices and price key). To move the app or copy it to a new computer, move or copy the whole folder.

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22. Glossary

Word	Meaning
All-time high (ATH)	The highest price an index or stock has ever closed at.
Annualized return	A trade's return stretched or shrunk to a one-year rate, so short and long trades can be compared.
Assigned	The buyer of your option used it: you bought shares (put) or sold them (call).
Break-even	The stock price at which a trade neither makes nor loses money. For a sold put: strike minus premium.
Called away	Your shares were sold because a covered call you sold was assigned.
Cash-secured put	A put you sell while keeping enough cash to buy the shares.
Contract	One option, covering 100 shares.
Cost basis	What you paid per share.
Covered call	A call you sell on shares you own.
Delta (Δ)	Roughly the chance an option ends in the money.
DTE	Days to expiry.
Expiry	The last day of an option.
Implied volatility (IV)	How much movement the option's price expects. Higher IV means higher premium.
In the money (ITM)	A put with the stock below the strike, or a call with the stock above it.
IV Rank (IVR)	Where today's IV sits within its own past year, from 0 to 100.
Net credit	Money received minus money paid, for a roll.
Open interest (OI)	How many contracts of that option exist. Higher is easier to trade.
Out of the money (OTM)	A put with the stock above the strike, or a call with the stock below it.
P/E	Share price divided by yearly profit per share.
Premium	The price of an option, per share.
Probability of profit (PoP)	The estimated chance the trade makes money.
Roll	Buy back an option and sell a new one on the same stock, usually later.
Strike	The price the shares would change hands at.
Unrealised	Profit you would keep if you closed open trades now.
Win rate	The percent of closed trades that made money.

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